National School Curriculum

Class IX
English Textbook



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Department of School Education (DSE)
Ministry of Education and Skills Development (MoESD)
Royal Government of Bhutan


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This book is compiled and printed for educational purposes exclusively for schools in Bhutan.

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Foreword

Following the advent of modern education in the country, the English language has been given an important place along with Dzongkha, the national language. English has, in fact, been the language of instruction for many school subjects, and it has served our purpose well even outside the curriculum.

The emphasis of the English curriculum is on the improvement of language skills of students, on literature studies written in the contemporary English language, the inclusion of non-fiction writing and changes in the approach to the assessment of students' performance. The curriculum also demands a change in the way in which students are taught, specifically a movement away from the teacher-centred classroom to a gender-sensitive, student-centred learning environment. This means that the teacher is responsible for designing activities that promote active learning while the students play a greater role in their own learning. The teacher will act as a facilitator to allow students to explore and create knowledge.

The selection of texts represents a conscious and rigorous effort to bring to our classrooms an assortment of rich and varied literary experiences presented through different genres which celebrate the dignity of content and the beauty of language.

The plans put forward in the curriculum offer a balanced programme with adequate instructional time to develop the skills in each strand of Reading & Literature, Writing, Listening, Speaking and the Use of English. The goal is to provide adequate time to learn these skills so that students are able to communicate with eloquence and receive the communication of others with respect and clarity.

The Ministry of Education and Skills Development hopes that the English Curriculum will open the doors to new opportunities for our students to improve their English language skills. The learning programmes in the curriculum will ensure that they will acquire the knowledge to continue higher studies and the skills they require to become competent communicators–in reading, writing, listening and speaking as required in the workplace and society.

The Ministry wishes to acknowledge the valuable contributions of the teachers and teacher-educators to the development of the curriculum.

Tashi Delek.

Tashi Namgyal

Director

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Introduction

This English textbook has been developed with the aim of nurturing thoughtful, skilled, and responsible learners within the Bhutanese context, while preparing them to engage confidently with the wider world. Through a carefully selected collection of short stories, essays, and poems, the book reflects local values and experiences alongside voices from other cultures, helping students appreciate both their own heritage and the diversity of global perspectives.

The short stories present situations and characters that explore moral choices, relationships, and challenges relevant to students' lives in Bhutan and beyond. They encourage learners to reflect on values such as compassion, integrity, community living, respect for nature, and harmony—principles that resonate strongly with Bhutanese society and the philosophy of Gross National Happiness. The essays develop critical thinking by addressing social, cultural, and contemporary issues, guiding students to analyse ideas, form reasoned opinions, and communicate them effectively. The poems celebrate language, emotion, and imagination, drawing attention to the beauty of words while fostering sensitivity to human experiences across cultures.

In addition to strengthening reading, writing, speaking, and listening skills, this textbook aims to develop global competence. Students are encouraged to think beyond national boundaries, understand different viewpoints, and respond thoughtfully to global challenges while remaining grounded in Bhutanese identity and values. The activities and questions promote discussion, collaboration, creativity, and ethical thinking, helping learners become confident communicators and reflective citizens.

By engaging with the texts in this book, students will not only enhance their proficiency in English but also develop empathy, cultural awareness, and a lifelong love for reading. Ultimately, this textbook seeks to prepare learners to contribute positively to their communities and to the global society with wisdom, confidence, and responsibility.

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How to use this book

This book is divided into four sections–Short stories, Poems, Essays and Play. Although the contents of these texts are important, they should be used as means to achieve the learning objectives stated in the five strands of the curriculum. The learning objectives are in the preliminary pages of the book, and they should be the focus of your study. Therefore, it is vital to ask yourself whether you have achieved the knowledge, skills or values stated by the objectives.

You will find the following under each text of all the sections:

Title: the topic of the text.
Genre: the type or subtype of the text.

GETTING STARTED

Will activate your prior knowledge about what you are going to study, therefore allowing you to build on and make connection with what you already know about the topic or concepts.

The text: the main text for reading. You will read the text with the help of the teacher and explore meanings by engaging at different levels of cognitive, affective and psychomotor domains of learning.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

This section provides brief biographical information about the writer, including their background, notable works, and literary achievements. Understanding the author's life and context helps you appreciate and connect more deeply with the text.

KEY TERMS

Under this you will find the definitions or explanations of important words or phrases that you will come across in the text.

LEARNING EXPERIENCE

With the help of the teacher, you will engage in different learning activities and experiences to achieve the objectives. You will respond to what you read, how you feel and interpret the text.

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REFLECTION

You will write a brief or extended paper on what you have learnt–how the learning experiences have helped you to grow in terms of cognitive, emotion or in behaviour. Reflecting and responding to the text helps create meaning and deepens understanding. It will also allow you the make personal connections with the character(s), themes and contexts of the text.

EXPLORE FURTHER

This task will assign you to read another text, not in this book, and compare and contrast the two texts in terms of themes, text structure and narrative styles, among others.

REVIEW

appears at the end of each section. The activities under this will allow you to carry out a critical self-assessment of what you have learnt in the entire section.

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Learning objectives

Learning Objectives serve as indicators of achievement at each class level in reference to the standards. These objectives are inter- related and it will not normally be possible or desirable to assess them in isolation. The Learning Objectives encompass knowledge, skills and values for each class level. Teachers should identify additional concepts/topics and essential skills that best fits the teaching and learning activities.

Reading & Literature
Learners should be introduced to various genres and subgenres of texts on a wide range of topics to achieve the following objectives:

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Sl.no	Objectives	Core Concepts and Skills
1	Read and understand explicit details, ideas and arguments in various fiction and nonfiction texts.	Possess reading comprehension skills to understand both explicit details and broader ideas and arguments in different types of texts including fiction and non-fiction.
2	Identify and comprehend ideas, opinions, and attitudes in various texts, along with the relationships between them.	Identifying and comprehending the main points, messages or theme, opinions and attitudes. Understanding the relationship between ideas, opinions and attitude.
3	Select relevant details when reading for a specific purpose.	Reading for a specific purpose means looking for information that directly helps in achieving a goal. It includes applying reading skills like previewing, identifying relevant details, skimming and scanning, note-taking or organizing details and verifying relevance.
4	identify and understand the literal and implied meanings in various texts.	Understanding the literal meaning, understanding the implied meaning using the clues from the texts, often hidden in the author's attitude, theme or the message. Analysing the tone, word choice, actions and relationships
5	Examine how the use of different narrative styles and techniques to create an intended effect on the readers.	Identifying narrative perspective, highlighting narrative techniques (dialogue, flashback, foreshadow, imagery etc) Considering the effect on the reader) emotions, understanding, engagement etc) Connecting the style and techniques to the author's purpose (suspense, empathy, humour etc)

Writing

Learners should be taught and be asked to practise writing for different purposes and audiences using the features of the respective genre or subgenre. They should use register and tone appropriate to the purpose and audience. Learners should be encouraged to follow the writing process to help them achieve the following objectives:

Sl.no	Objectives	Core Concepts and Skills
1	Produce written texts demonstrating accurate use of grammatical structures, appropriate vocabulary, correct punctuation, and spelling.	Knowledge of grammar and syntax, vocabulary and word choice, punctuation and mechanics, editing and proof reading and organization.
2	Create written texts using appropriate grammatical structures and vocabulary.	Knowledge and skills to use sentences, paragraphs or the to organise the entire text. Sentence structure: simple, compound, complex sentences. Paragraph structure: Topic sentence, supporting details, concluding sentence. Text structure: Introduction, body and conclusion. Logical sequencing: ideas arranged in a clear and coherent order.
3	Organize written texts coherently by employing appropriate lexical cohesions.	Use of words and phrases to link ideas across sentences and paragraphs so as to make writing flow naturally. Some of the ways to achieve lexical cohesion include: repetition of key terms, use of synonyms or near-synonyms, collocations, pronouns and demonstratives and transition words and phrases.
4	Use appropriate register, structure and style that suits the purpose and audience	Register is the level of formality in language. Structure is how the ideas are organised and style refers to the writer's voice and how language is used to make writing engaging, clear and suitable to the audience and purpose.
5	Convey information, ideas, and arguments with clarity and depth, ensuring appropriate elaboration and support aligned to the text's purpose.	The intended audience and purpose, organizing ideas logically, elaborating with explanations, examples and analysis, supporting arguments with evidence and reasoning, and using precise, clear and consistent language.

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Listening

Learners should be familiarized with a range of audio texts or 'live' conversations and dialogues on a variety of topics. They should be taught active and critical listening, among others, to achieve the following listening skills:

Sl.no	Objectives	Core Concepts and Skills
1	Listen to acquire details and specific information from various spoken sources.	To listen effectively for details and specific information from spoken sources (such as conversations, lectures, news reports, or instructions), a listener needs to develop a set of focused listening skills like active listening, discriminative listening, identifying cues, inference-making, predictive listening, among others.
2	Identify and show the connections of the speaker's message, opinions, and attitudes in various spoken contexts and sources.	Analytical listening skills and interpretive strategies. Skills to differentiate between facts and opinions, understanding attitudes and evaluating how links are made to connect the message supported by opinions and attitudes.
3	Make links between the speaker's ideas, opinions, feelings, and attitudes in various spoken contexts.	Active listening, identifying main ideas and supporting details, recognizing facts versus opinions, recognizing tone and attitude, emotional awareness, inference and interpretation, comparative listening.
4	Demonstrate understanding of the implicit meaning of spoken texts.	Active listening, context awareness, inference skills, recognizing tone and attitude, detecting bias or hidden opinions, understanding figurative language, interpreting non-verbal cues, comparing what is said vs what is not said.

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Speaking
Learners should be encouraged and given as much opportunities as possible to speak in different situations and purposes so that they develop skills to:

Sl.no	Objectives	Core Concepts and Skills
1	Use accurate pronunciation and appropriate intonation to communicate effectively.	Speaking skills like phonemic accuracy, stress and rhythm control, intonation awareness and expressive delivery.
2	Express ideas clearly by using varied grammatical structures and word patterns that suit the intended audience and purpose.	Grammatical control, sentence variety, lexical control, appropriate register and logical organization.
3	Participate actively in different types of interactions.	Listening and comprehension, speaking and expression, and interaction and collaboration.
4	Convey information, ideas, and opinions with clarity, expanding responses through examples, justifications, comparisons, and specula-tions across a range of topics	The essential skills required are clarity in language, elaboration with examples and reasoning, logical structuring, and flexible use of comparisons and speculations—all tailored to suit the topic and audience.

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A Grain of Mustard Seed by Edith Pargeter from Oxford Reading Circle, Oxford University Press

I've Got Gloria by M.E. Kerr, Reading & Literature, Class IX, REC

Road Not Taken by Robert Frost, Reading & Literature, Class IX, REC

I Know Why the Caged Bird Sings by Maya Angelou, Reading & Literature, Class IX, REC

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Essay
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The Dignity of Work

Charles Finn

persuasive essay

GETTING STARTED

1. What comes to your mind when you read the title 'The Dignity of Work'? Think and share with the class.
2. Why do you think certain jobs are given more respect than others, even though every job is important for society to function?

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'No person ever stood lower in my estimation for having a patch in their clothes.'

We work in factories, on farms, in blazing sun, and on the sides of the roads, in forests, in ditches. You see us in shipyards, apartment buildings, under your cars. Ask us our names: We're Alex, Rob, Peter, and Hank. We're Sally, Susan, Deborah, and Pam.

What do we do? We bring home a pay cheque, fibreglass in our lungs, and have a few beers. We're what people call working stiffs. We feel that way. We have strong backs, set minds, and dirt under our nails. We look you straight in the eye. It's no joke, we say. We have bills to pay.

The other day I was standing in a drugstore looking through a rack of greeting cards. My greasy overalls and thick fingers confirmed I belonged to the dented pickup outside. Turning the carousel, my eyes fell on a black-and-white photo of a well-dressed man and a woman standing on the corner of a busy city street. They were holding a cardboard sign that read, "Will work for latte." The card got an audible chuckle out of me, more of a snicker really, but my amusement was quickly followed by a very real sadness. It seemed to me the card was exposing a general callousness toward the plight of the poor, and I felt a slight embarrassment because of my filthy clothes.

Still holding the card, I looked around at the other casual but well-dressed customers. I'm not poor, I wanted to tell them, just trying to get by. Then I thought of how many times I'd been to urban centres and walked past the homeless, putting a few coins in their cups but avoiding their eyes. Such uneasiness, I believe, is an indicator of an increasingly harmful society; the accumulated buildup of guilt, silent, yet a subtle crippler of soul.

There was also an undercurrent of classism the card hinted at. Although fictitious, I could hardly imagine this couple accepting a minimum-wage job as high-school janitor or letting themselves sink to the status of a construction labourer like me. It was Thoreau who said, "No person ever stood lower in my estimation for having a patch in their clothes."

The knees of my pants were testimonies to what Henry David would probably have viewed as frugality. These days it's called hard luck, and it goes along with the attitude that to work with your hands implies you don't have the wherewithal to work with your head. The assumption is if you sit at a computer you're more useful than if you mix cement for a living.

To her credit, my mother has always supported me no matter what occupation I've tried, even as a banger of nails, but there are friends who continually ask me when I'm going to get a real job. I'd like to ask them how real is the mechanic that fixes their car when it breaks down, or the nurse who empties bedpans for a living? A doctor is a vital part of any community. So, too, the man who comes every week to haul away garbage.

Still in the store, I realized it's not the odd greeting card, or the media as a whole teaching this classism, it's adults. Too often we're not proud of ourselves or the jobs that we do.

We think people with degrees and white-collar jobs are the only ones worthy to hold their heads in the air. Don't become a farmer, we say to our children. There's no money in that. With this subtle form of bigotry, our children are growing up believing the lower classes are lower beings. We're teaching them a person's worth is gauged by economic, not moral, success.

I didn't buy that card. I went home and reheated some chili. In the shower I scrubbed the tar from my hands and looked down at my feet. Chips of sawdust were being washed out of my hair and sliding past my toes. Each one represented a skill I'd learned and a few pennies earned. Looking in the mirror I was proud of my working-class tan and before going to bed, I fixed my lunch for the next day and set the alarm.

Then for the hell of it, or maybe in defiance, I made a large decaf latte and read for an hour in bed. I told my partner I'd had a good day.

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ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Charles C. Finn is an American poet and writer, born in 1941. He is known for his works on spirituality, life, and social issues. He grew up in Cincinnati, Ohio, studied Literature and Psychology at Loyola University, and later worked as a professional counselor in Roanoke, Virginia. He authored the essay 'The Dignity of Work' to convey that all work, whether physically demanding or humble, deserves respect and recognition.

KEY TERMS

dignity: the quality of being worthy of respect and honour

classism: unfair or prejudiced treatment of people based on their social class

white-collar job: a type of job that involves office work, administrative work or professional work

carousel: a rotating structure where things are displayed in a shop

bigotry: having a strong, unreasonable dislike or intolerance towards people who are different.

latte: a popular coffee drink made with espresso and steamed milk, usually topped with a little foam

wherewithal: the money, resources or ability needed to do something

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LEARNING EXPERIENCE

1. Answer the following questions.

   a. What emotions does the writer experience upon seeing the photo of a well-dressed man and woman holding a cardboard sign that reads, 'Will work for latte'?

   b. How does the author describe the differences and similarities between blue-collar and white-collar jobs? Provide examples to support your answer.

   c. In what ways does the author elaborate adults prejudice towards different types of works?

   d . What point of view does the essay use, and how does this chosen perspective shape the reader's understanding of its message?

   e. A persuasive essay established the writer's credibility, appeals to the reader's emotions, and presents logical arguments . Using the text, provide and write one evidence for each of these features.

LEARNING EXPERIENCE

2. Carry out activities as directed below.

   a. Discuss the four types of sentences based on their purposes: indicative, imperative, interrogative, and subjunctive. Provide an example for each from the text.

   b. Identify examples of discourse markers from the text, and use each in a sentence of your own.

REFLECTION

1. Why do Bhutanese youths struggle to secure employment, and what social, economic, or educational factors might explain this challenge?
2. How did the narrator's experiences change your perception of the comparative value and status of blue-collar vs. white-collar work?

EXPLORE FURTHER

1. *Why students should eat breakfast every day* (Persuasive essay)–supplementary text.
2. *Global warming* (Persuasive essay)–supplementary text.

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Bhutan: Biodiverse Diamond of the Himalayas

Robin Smilie

expository essay

GETTING STARTED

What knowledge, experiences, or personal observations can you share about Bhutan's biological diversity and the factors that contribute to it? Use the KWL chart below to record your knowledge.

K- What I **Know**.	**W**- What I **want** to learn.	**L**- What I **learnt**.

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Like a jewelled bracelet crusted with large and small stones, the Himalayan Mountains stretch for 1,500 miles from Kashmir to Assam. The tiniest diamond of the four countries that make up the Himalayas is Bhutan. In terms of biological diversity and retention of native habitat – acre for acre – Bhutan is the richest country in Asia. Christened as the "Land of the Thunder Dragon", it is one of the most biological diverse countries in the world, on par with Madagascar and the tropical rainforest countries in Central and South America.



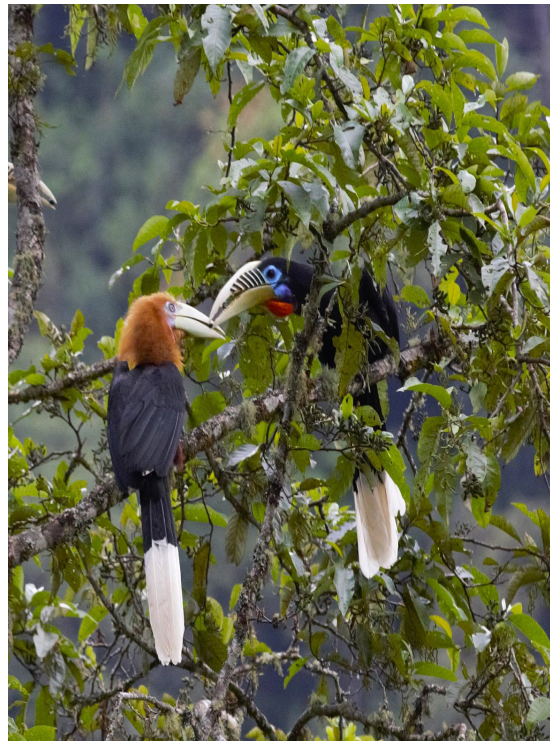
While the meaning of the word Himalaya is "abode of snow", one should not think that Bhutan's landscape is made up solely of permanently covered snowcapped peaks or alpine scrub zones. Several distinctly different biological realms converge between the low-lying rain forest in the south and the alpine meadows in the north – the altitude difference is nearly 24,000 feet.

Situated in the heartland of Bhutan, between these two regions, are vast rhododendron and conifer forests. With heavy rains of the monsoon season and different climates associated with varying altitudes, it is easy to see how biodiversity has been able to take hold of the country.



Within the scientific community, Bhutan's list of rare and endangered wildlife and fauna is legendary: Bengal tigers sighted above 2,900 meters, snow leopards, golden languor, blue sheep, red panda, takin, black-necked crane, over 600 species of birds – 70 discovered in the last ten years, over 5,000 plants, many of which contain medicinal properties, rare orchids, carnivorous plants, and 50 species of rhododendrons round up the list. One species of bird, the Satyr Tragopan, was once thought to be extinct but was recently sighted in Jigme Dorji National Park. Several white bellied heron, one of the fifty rarest birds on the planet with a population estimated between 20 and 200, have been recently sighted a number of times.

The challenge of conserving these national, indeed, world treasures, has fallen on various government agencies that are charged by the King and the National Assembly with policies that mandate strict conservation of Bhutan's natural wonders. A trust fund has been set up for environmental conservation. In 1995, the National Assembly passed a resolution that the country must maintain no less than 60 per cent of its area under forest cover (Bhutan currently has approximately 70 percent of its area under forest cover). These forests are home to some of the rarest plants and animals in the world.





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For many conservations, the crown jewel of Bhutan's effort to maintain biodiversity are the "biological corridors" that connect four national parks, four wildlife sanctuaries, and one nature preserve. These nine areas make up 26 per cent of the country's total land area, with the corridors accounting for another 9 per cent.

The purpose of these biological or ecological corridors is to prevent fragmentation of natural habitats by preserving the connection between protected areas. The parks and conservation areas might otherwise be separated by human activities such as farming and other developments. When a species is cut off from its main population, i.e. its genetic pool, sub-species begin to develop. The genetic survival of the new and smaller population is more difficult. By designing this system of interconnecting corridors, Bhutan has made significant strides to promote the survival of future generations of its diverse ecosystems.



Presently, the most significant ecotourism area of Bhutan is Jigme Dorje National Park, the largest protected area within the country, where popular trekking routes cross rivers at 1,400 metres and traverse mountains that soar to 7,000 metres. Visitation within the park is confined to visitor zones. Bhutan is approaching development of ecotourism even more cautiously than it has approached general tourism, recognising that areas of tiger habitat and rare medicinal plants cannot withstand an onslaught of tourists.

In an effort to pursue ecotourism, while protecting the environment, new efforts are being implemented to promote community-based tourism and trekking. This new approach actively engages the local community in development and management of ecotourism, as well as promoting the conservation of nature.

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Religion plays a role

Bhutan remains the only surviving Mahayana Buddhist country in the world. To live in harmony with the mysteries and complexities of nature is a crucial Buddhist practice. One has only to look at acid rain, the ozone hole, and contamination of the earth's waters to realise how mankind harms itself by harming nature. The Buddhist approach to nature is to show reverence and compassion to all forms of life, as well as limiting consumption to basic needs, i.e. food, shelter and clothing.



The Buddhist philosophy, coupled with longstanding belief that the key ecological areas are inhabited by underworld spirits, gods and goddesses, as well as a variety of deities have served to protect much of Bhutan's landscape. If the local people believe that a powerful deity resides in a certain lake, then they will not pollute the stream originating from it. Likewise, if a certain forest is thought to be the home of gods and goddesses, the trees of that forest are not hewed. Since habitat preservation is a key element in preservation of species such belief encourages a culture that supports biodiversity and conservation of natural resources.

The world scientific community recognises that Bhutan has a significant portion of the planet's remaining rare and endangered species. It is, therefore, actively assisting the kingdom in its efforts to balance environmental management and economic development.



With the help of these worldwide stakeholders, the government and people of Bhutan, and every person that visits Bhutan, we do hope that this biodiverse diamond of the Himalayas will continue to shine forever.

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ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Robin Smillie of Tampa, Florida, is a professional photographer known for leading small adventure tours to Bhutan. Having visited the country numerous times, he is regarded as an expert on Bhutanese travel and contributes photographs and stories to the Bhutanese Tourism Authority and Royal Bhutan Airlines. He authored the essay 'Bhutan: Biodiverse Diamond of the Himalayas' for Rainbow Photo Tours, which is also reflected in the Journal of Educational Action Research and in Tashi Delek Magazine, Druk Air Corporation. In his essay, Smillie highlights Bhutan's rich biodiversity and emphasises its importance for conservation.

KEY TERMS

biodiversity: the variety of life in a particular habitat or on Earth.

native: belonging naturally to a specific place, not introduced from elsewhere

species: a group of living organisms that are similar and can breed with each other to produce fertile offspring

sanctuary: a protected area where animals and plants are safe from hunting or destruction.

corridor: a strip of natural habitat that connects separate protected areas allowing animals to move safely between them

carbon negative: a condition in which a country, community, actively removes more carbon dioxide from the atmosphere than it emits, helping reduce global warming

LEARNING EXPERIENCE

1. After reading the passage, list the key facts or examples under each of the following headings:

   a. Bhutan's biodiversity

   b. Conservation policies

   c. Endangered species

   d. Forest coverage

   e. Buddhist Philosophy on Nature Conservation

2. In pairs, assume the roles of an animal and a journalist. The journalist will interview the animal about its population, food, habitats, and threats. The animal should reflect and respond thoughtfully to each questions.

3. Answer the following questions.

   a. In the first paragraph,how does the write make Bhutan stand out among its neigbours?

   b. Do you think Bhutan could have been able to maintain its rich biodiversity, if Buddhism had not been its dominant religion? Elaborate on your response.

   c. Identify and describe the important values communicated in the essay.

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CONTINUED

d. Bhutan is often called a 'biodiverse diamond.' Discuss the significance of this metaphor in describing the country's ecology.

e. Identify and write rhetorical devices used in the essay. Then explain how the use of these rhetorical devices enhance the values and themes.

f. Explain the features of an expository essay using examples from the text.

4. Complete the table with examples if synonyms and antonyms.

Word	Synonym	Word	Antonym
scarce		foreign	
wildlife		small	
diedout		difficult	
breaking apart		permit	

5. Pick the word pairs from the table and put them under the correct column.

Pair - A	Pair - B	Pair - C	Homophones	Homonyms	Homographs
bank-bank	right – right	bark - bark			
sea – see	tear - tear	knight - knight			
lead - lead	fair - fare	present – present			
flower - flour	row - row	one - won			
bat – bat	pair - pear	close – close			
	bow – bow	brake – break			
		wind – wind			

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CONTINUED

6. Explore the use of verb phrases, noun phrases, and prepositional phrases. Provide at least two examples each from the text. An example has been done for you.

   a. Noun phrase: the covered snowcapped peaks

   b. Verb phrase: Has passed a resolution

   c. Prepositional phrase: on the plane

7. Complete the table below using information from the essay, incorporating the key features of information transfer. Then, explore other forms of information transfer with your teacher.

Areas	Information from the text
Geographical Identity & Location	
National Identity & Name	
Biological Diversity Status	
Altitude and Landscape	
Forest Cover Mandate	
Protected Area Network	
Biological Corridors	
Wildlife Discoveries & Counts	
Flagship Endangered Species	
Ecotourism Strategy	

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REFLECTION

How might large projects like the Gelephu Mindfulness City affect Bhutan's biodiversity?

EXPLORE FURTHER

1. *Action Research (JEAR) CERD*. Vol. 1, No.3, November 2028
2. *INTO THE AMAZON FORESTS OF BHUTAN: Phibsoo Wildlife Sanctuary*

A Morning in Malgudi

R.K Narayan

descriptive essay

GETTING STARTED

1. How do the early activities in a town reveal the lifestyle of its people?
2. Write for 3 minutes describing a typical morning in your village/town. Include people, activities, smells, sounds and emotions. Share your piece with the class.
3. What makes the marketplace busy and noisy? Share your opinions with the group.

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The sun had only just begun to stretch its pale arms across the tiled rooftops of Malgudi when I stepped out of my house, still clutching the last traces of sleep in my eyes. The air carried a mild chill, the kind that announces the retreat of night but has not yet surrendered to the heat of the approaching day. It was the hour when Malgudi, half-awake and half-dreaming, prepared itself for another ordinary yet remarkable morning.

From the corner of Kabir Street came the metallic clatter of shutters being lifted—Shankar, the ever-dutiful shopkeeper, opening his provisions store. He yawned loudly, as if declaring to the world that he deserved applause for beginning his work on time. A few steps ahead, the old peepal tree stood silent, its roots gripping the earth like an ancient guardian. Sparrows hopped cheerfully around it, chirping with an enthusiasm unmatched by any human resident of the town.

I turned toward Market Road, the spine of Malgudi, where life in all its shapes and habits eventually converged. The tea shop run by Mani, a bald man with an enormous moustache, was already steaming with activity. From a distance, one could hear the whistle of his kettle, followed by the rhythmic tap-tap of steel tumblers being arranged on the counter. Aromatic waves of boiling tea, ginger, and warm milk drifted toward me, tempting me to abandon all plans and sit there for the next hour.

A few regulars were already seated on the wooden benches—an old pensioner reading the day's paper with exaggerated seriousness, a young man rehearsing explanations he would offer his employer for arriving late, and a schoolboy struggling to keep the strap of his bulging bag from slipping off his shoulder. They all drank tea as if it were a sacred ritual, their eyes half-closed, their minds still shedding the residue of sleep.

Just as I was about to take a turn toward the riverbank, I heard the familiar squeak of a bicycle approaching from behind. It was the postman, Rama, pedaling with the dignity of a man carrying the fate of households in his canvas bag.

He rang his bell twice—once to announce his presence, and once again for the sheer pleasure of hearing its sharp ding echo across the empty street. “Letter for you today?” he asked with a mischievous grin. “When has Malgudi ever allowed me such excitement?” I replied. He laughed, wished me a good day, and pedalled away, leaving behind a faint scent of dust, ink, and warm human sincerity.

The river Sarayu shimmered ahead—calm, broad, and bearing the reflections of early sunlight like a sheet of polished brass. Fishermen in knee-deep water cast their nets with slow, practised motions. Near the steps leading down to the river, a few women washed clothes, beating the wet fabric against smooth stones in a rhythmic cadence that blended seamlessly with the morning breeze. Their chatter floated through the air—fragmented stories of husbands, prices of vegetables, and the mischief of children.

I sat on a stone ledge and watched the river slide past. It carried with it a silent wisdom—a reminder that life, no matter how chaotic, moved forward with dignity. From the opposite bank, the temple bell rang, its resonant hum travelling across the water like an ancient greeting. The priest, a man with a round belly and a perpetually flustered expression, hurried about lighting lamps and arranging flowers. His assistant, a boy not older than ten, followed him like a loyal shadow.

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As the sun climbed higher, Malgudi began to shake off its slumber. The marketplace awakened noisily. Vegetable vendors took their assigned positions with territorial pride, arranging brinjals, tomatoes, and gourds in neat little pyramids. The aroma of freshly cut coriander leaves filled the air. Carts creaked. Cows ambled. Children ran about without purpose except the universal duty of childhood—to create noise and laughter.

At the corner near Lawley Road, the bus stand grew steadily more chaotic. A man waving a newspaper chased after a departing bus, convinced that sheer willpower could stop its massive wheels. A mother scolded her son for eating the snacks she had packed for the journey before it had even begun. The conductor shouted the bus route in such rapid succession that it sounded like a chant rather than information.

I returned to Kabir Street, where the morning had now fully settled. The barber’s shop had begun its day’s business. Men waited on a long bench, sharing the town’s freshest gossip—who had bought new land, whose daughter had run away with the grocer’s nephew, and which astrologer’s

prediction had once again proven disastrously wrong. The barber nodded solemnly at all these stories, though he rarely believed any of them.

As I approached my home, the gentle clinking of vessels signaled that my mother was preparing breakfast. The smell of frying onions wafted out, making my stomach growl in impatient protest. A milkman cycled by, ringing his bell with the confidence of a man who knew every household depended on him for survival. I paused for a moment before entering the house and looked around. The street was now alive— doors open, voices rising, footsteps echoing. Malgudi, in all its modest charm, had blossomed from its early-morning stillness into a bustling little world of its own.

It was an ordinary morning—perhaps no different from thousands that had passed before it. But in its ordinariness lay its quiet beauty. Every corner, every sound, every familiar face carried the comfort of belonging. And as I stepped inside, leaving the street behind, I felt the same warmth one feels when returning from a small but pleasant journey.

DRAFT

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Rasipuram Krishnaswami Iyer Narayanaswami (R.K.Narayan) was born on 10 October 1906 in Madras, Tamil Nadu, in British India. He studied at Maharaja College in Mysore and briefly worked as a school teacher before writing his first novel, 'Swami and Friends', in 1930. In this debut work, Narayan created 'Malgudi', the fictional South Indian town that became the central setting of all his fifteen novels and most of his six short-story collections. As his writing evolved, so did Malgudi—from the quiet, small-town atmosphere of Swami and Friends to a more settled, middle-class community in later works such as 'The Bachelor of Arts' (1937) and 'The English Teacher' (1945).

KEY TERMS

provision: a supply of food, materials, or necessary items prepared in advance

cadence: the natural rise and fall of a person's voice while speaking

flustered: feeling confused, nervous or embarrassed, especially because of too much activity or pressure

conductor: a person who collects fares and assists passengers on a bus/train

LEARNING EXPERIENCE

1. Uisng the USSR strategy (**Uninterrupted- Sustained- Silent- Reading**), identify the descriptive words from the text, for nouns and verbs given in the table below.

Nouns	Describing words - (Adjective)	Verbs	Modifier - (Adverb)
arm		yawned	
moustache		hopped	
milk		awakened	
man		nodded	

2. The following sentences, extracted from the essay, are without punctuation. Rewrite each sentence using the correct punctuation.

   a. He yawned loudly as if declaring to the world that he deserved applause

   b. When does Malgudi ever allow me such excitement

   c. Letter for you today he asked with a mischievous grin

   d. The vegetable vendors sold many items brinjals tomatoes gourds and coriander

   e. When has Malgudi ever allowed me such excitement I replied

3. Identify the types of dashes (emdash, hyphen and endash) in the following sentences and explain their usage.

   a. metallic clatter of shutters being lifted—Shankar

   b. their eyes half-closed

   c. He rang his bell twice—once to announce his presence.

4. For the types of imagery given in the table below, provide suitable examples from the text.

Audio (hear)	Visual (see)	Gustatory (taste)	Olfactory (smell)	Tactile (touch)	Kinesthetic (movement)

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CONTINUED

5. Answer the questions below.

   a. Identify and discuss the key features of a descriptive essay in your group.

   b. What narrative structure does the essay use? If the structure had been different, how might the content or information presented in the essay have changed?

   c. Imagine a morning in contemporary *Malgudi*. Using technology, infrastructure, and education as reference points, creat a vivid the scene. This activity can be completed individually or in groups.

   d. Identify examples of figurative language used by the author in the essay to express the intended message?

   e. For the 'Flip the Script' activity, find a stereotyped female character from the essay and rewrite her role to challege the stereotype.

Flip the Script

Procedure:

1. Work individually or in pairs.
2. Find one example from the essay where a woman's role is stereotyped.
3. Flip the Script: Rewrite the scene showing the woman in a non-stereotypical role, for example, independent, decision-making, or influential.
4. Share your idea with the class in 1–2 minutes. You can act it, draw it, or tell it.
   Fun Twist: You can add a little role-play or comic-style drawing to make it creative.

   f. What kind of person do you think the narrator is? Use evidence from the text to support your opinion.

6. Study the table below and write examples of your own.

Terms	Contains Subject?	Contains verbs?	Complete thought?	Example from the essay	Give examples of your own
Dependent Clause	Yes	Yes	No	Because the sun had only just begun to stretch its pale arms.	
Independent clause	Yes	Yes	Yes	Shankar opened his provisions store.	

DRAFT

REFLECTION

Reflect on an event in your neighbourhood that reveals your relationship with your community.

EXPLORE FURTHER

1. *The Voice of the City* by O. Henry
2. *A Piece of Chalk* by G. K. Chesterton

DRAFT

The War on Drugs

Extracted from Academic Encounters. (2004). Reading, Study Skills and Writing by Kristine Brown & Susan Hood, Cambridge University Press.

argumentative essay

GETTING STARTED

1. Imagine the life of teenagers who are struggling with drug addiction. What factors might have influenced them to start using drugs?
2. What action should the government and the society take to prevent or reduce drug use? Discuss with your friends.

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Over the last few decades, the drug problem in the United States (and in many other industrialized countries) has become considerably worse. In 1981, there were about 3 million drug addicts in the United States; today, there are around 6 million. The number of drug overdose deaths and drug-related homicides has also increased. This is in spite of the fact that the government has spent more and more money in trying to solve the drug problem. The fight against drugs is often referred to as a "war" or "battle," and most experts now believe the battle against drugs has been a failure. They say it has failed because the government has focused on controlling the problem through laws and punishments, rather than through drug education and treatment.

The failure of the law-enforcement approach has led to calls for other approaches to solving the problem, including the decriminalization and the legalization of drugs. Advocates of decriminalization think that drug users should no longer be labeled as serious criminals and that the punishments for drug use should be significantly reduced. Advocates of legalization believe there should be no restriction on drug use at all, and that individuals should be able to buy drugs the same way they buy cigarettes and alcohol today.

Those who are in favor of legalization argue that the current drug laws do more harm than good. They argue that the current laws waste police time because while police officers are busy arresting people for smoking marijuana, they are not doing the work of arresting robbers and murderers. Further, they argue that the high cost of illegal drugs and the enormous amounts of money to be made from drug dealing encourage more serious crimes. For example, many drug users turn to stealing to support their habit and police can sometimes be bribed to "look the other way." Finally, those who support legalization believe on law enforcement could be used for drug treatment and education, which would drastically reduce drug use.

Those who oppose legalization respond that, if drugs are legalized, drug use and addiction will skyrocket. They point to the experience with alcohol, which was prohibited in the United States in the 1920s. At the end of this period, called Prohibition, the consumption of alcohol apparently soared by 350 percent (Bennet 1989). Others feel that the use of drugs is a stepping stone to other crimes – that, for example, the use of marijuana leads to the use of heroin or cocaine, and on to more serious crime. If drug use is stopped, this trend will be prevented.

Another aspect of the debate on whether or not drugs should be legalized involves the question of individual rights. Some people call for legalization because they feel they have the right to take drugs – that it is none of the government's business. They think that laws governing this behavior are an invasion of individual rights. On the other hand, others argue that the government should try to protect us from harming ourselves.

Finally, there are those who believe that the problem of widespread drug abuse and crime can only be solved when the government attacks the root causes of the problem: poverty, racism and inequality (Currie 1993). They propose that the government should deal with the factors that cause the problem by providing employment for all, increasing the minimum wage, improving health care for the poor, offering paid family leave, and providing affordable housing.

Adapted from Academic Encounters (2004). Reading, Study Skills and Writing by Kristine Brown & Susan Hood, Cambridge University Press.

DRAFT

KEY TERMS

claim: main opinion

evidence: facts or examples that support an opinion

thesis statement: the main argument of the whole essay

counterargument: an opposing viewpoint

rebuttal: a reply that shows the counterargument is weak

pros: the positive points or advantages

cons: the negative points or disadvantages

LEARNING EXPERIENCE

1. Use the information from the essay to answer the following questions.
   a. Why do experts think the "war on drugs" has failed in the United States?
   b. Why are the main reasons people oppose the legalisation of drugs?
   c. How do problems like poverty and inequality lead to drug use, and what solutions are suggested in the essay?
   d. The fight against drugs is often referred to as a 'war' or 'battle'. What are the literal meaning of these terms in the essay?
   e. Read the introduction carefully and identify the thesis statement.
   f. What three solutions does the author propose to address the drug problems?

2. Read the essay and fill in the table with the claim, evidence, counterargument, and refutation. An example has been done for you.

Claim 1	The current drug laws do more harm than good.
Evidence	While police are busy arresting marijuana users, serious crimes go unpunished; the high cost of illegal drugs encourages theft and bribery.
Counterargument	If drugs are legalised, drug use and addiction will skyrocket.
Refutation	However, law enforcement resources could be used for drug treatment and education, which would reduce drug use.
Claim 2	
Evidence	
Counterargument	
Refutation	
Claim 3	
Evidence	
Counterargument	
Refutation	

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CONTINUED

3. Decide whether each statement below is a fact or an opinion. Write 'F' for fact and 'O' for opinion.

   a. There were about 3 million drug addicts in the United States in 1981, and today there are around 6 million.

   b. The battle against drugs has been a complete failure because the government focused on punishment instead of treatment.

   c. Many drug users steal to support their habit because illegal drugs are very expensive.

   d. Legalising drugs will cause drug use and addiction to increase rapidly.

   e. Police time is wasted arresting people for smoking marijuana instead of catching robbers and murderers.

   f. The consumption of alcohol increased by 350% after Prohibition ended.

   g. Drug use is a "stepping stone" that automatically leads to more serious crimes.

   h. The government should protect people from harming themselves by using dangerous drugs.

4. Follow the writing process to write an argumentative essay on any of the topics below or a topic provided by your teacher.

   a. Students should be allowed to use mobile phones during school hours.

   b. Parents must give teenagers more freedom.

5. In groups, study the modal verbs given below, and discuss their meanings and usage. Then, write example sentences for each.

Modals	Usage	Examples
might	to express possibility, something that could happen but is not certain.	It **might** rain this afternoon, so you should carry an umbrella.
could	to tell about past ability, a polite request, possibility.	Law enforcement **could** be used for drug treatment and education, which would drastically reduce drug use
should	to give advice, obligation, expectation.	Drug users **should** no longer be labelled as serious criminals.

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CONTINUED

Modals	Usage	Examples
ought to	to give advice, moral obligation.	You **ought to** finish your homework before watching TV.
shall	to express suggestions, offers, or future actions (often formal).	**Shall** we go for a walk after class?
would	to express polite requests, hypothetical action.	I **would** help you, but I am busy right now.
must	to express necessity, a strong obligation.	You **must** wear a seatbelt while driving.
can	to express ability, possibility.	The problem of widespread drug abuse and crime **can** only be solved when the government attacks the root causes of the problem.
will	to describe future action, willingness	If drugs are legalised, drug use and addiction **will** skyrocket.

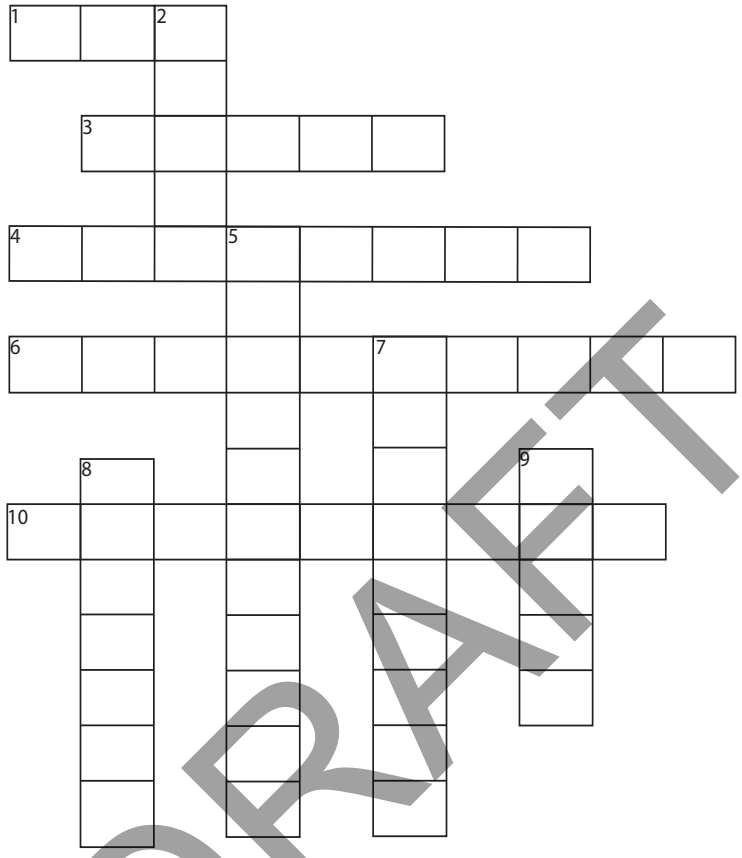
6. Explore the concept of simple, compound, and complex sentences. In pairs, use the text to write two examples of each type in the table below.

Type of sentence	Function	Textual example sentence	Two examples from the text
simple sentence	creates clarity, quick action	The number of drug overdose deaths and drug-related homicides has also increased.	
compound sentence	shows two events happening side by side	The fight against drugs is often referred to as a "war" or "battle," and most experts now believe the battle against drugs has been a failure.	
complex sentence	adds depth, explanation, or cause-effect		

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CONTINUED

6. Read the clue and fill in the crossword puzzle with the correct word from the text.



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ACROSS	DOWN
1. rule of the nation	2. very bad
3. harmful substance	5. band
4. more than required	7. kind of plant
6. consequences for breaking a rule	8. kinds of drugs
10. killing or murder	9. permit

8. Refer to the sample given below and write a report on the situations provided by your teacher.

The Growing Drug Problem and Ways to Address It

By Pema (Editor, School Magazine)

On 26 June 2025, "International Day Against Drug Abuse and Illicit Trafficking" was observed in the multi-purpose hall of Bajothang Higher Secondary School. The main objective of this initiative was to fulfil one of the Bhutan Narcotics Control Agency (BNCA) 's goals: to strengthen action and cooperation among community members to achieve an international society free of drug abuse. The occasion was attended by all students and staff of the school, along with visiting officials from BNCA.

The event started with a brief talk on how the drug problem in Bhutan has grown worse over the past few decades. The officials stated that the number of drug users has doubled, and drug-related deaths and crimes have increased, even though the government has spent a significant amount of money fighting drug use. They also mentioned that many experts believe the "war on drugs," which focuses on strict laws and punishment, has not been as successful as some think. Some experts argue that drugs should be legalised, claiming that current laws waste police time, make drugs expensive, and sometimes lead users to commit theft. Legalisation, they say, would allow more money to be used for treatment and education.

However, others strongly oppose legalisation, saying it would increase addiction, just as the number of tobacco users rose after the end of strict tobacco import regulations. They also believe drug use can lead to more serious crimes.

Finally, after the question-and-answer session, a consensus was reached that the problem can only be solved by addressing deeper issues such as poverty, inequality, and lack of opportunities.

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9. You have recently witnessed youths in your community indulging in the use of substances. Write a formal letter to the Director, Bhutan Narcotics Control Authority (BNCA), reporting the incident in detail and requesting stricter enforcement of laws to prevent such activities.

REFLECTION

Reflect on your experiences, observations, or beliefs about alcohol culture in your community.

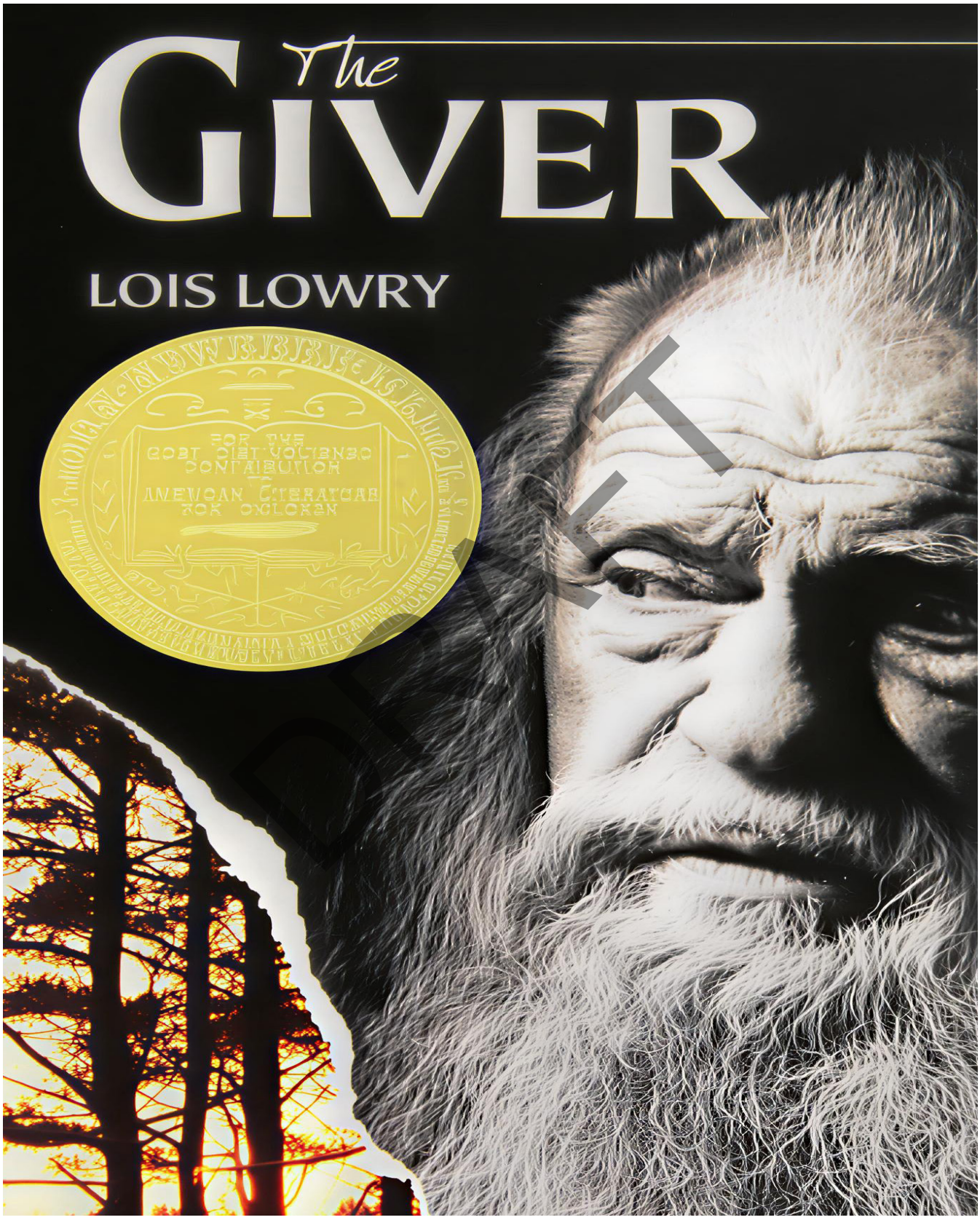
EXPLORE FURTHER

1. Exploring the Typical Features and Structure of an Argumentative Essay With a Sample Example.
2. Should Governments Ban Single-Use Plastics?

REVIEW

1. In the essay ‘The Dignity of Work’, why does the author emphasise that no work is superior or inferior?
2. Explain using an example from the essay to show how people can contribute meaningfully to society through different kinds of work.
3. What persuasive techniques does the author use to strengthen the argument about valuing every type of work?
4. Read the sentences below and label them as Declarative, Interrogative, Imperative, or Exclamatory.
   i. ‘Letter for you today?’ He asked with a mischievous grin.
   ii. ‘Take a turn toward the riverbank.’
   iii. ‘When has Malgudi ever allowed me such excitement?’
   iv. The river Sarayu shimmered ahead—calm, broad, and bearing the reflections of early
   v. sunlight like a sheet of polished brass.
5. Identify three examples of imagery from the essay ‘The Morning in Malgudi’.
6. Write an argumentative paragraph on any topic incorporating claim, evidence, counterargument, therefore, however, furthermore, consequence, issue, policy, argue, oppose and support, exactly once
7. Do you think Bhutan needs stricter rules for shopkeepers on the sale of tobacco products? Explain your ideas in a cause-and-effect essay.

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DRAFT

The Giver

Lois Lowry

science fiction

Chapter One

GETTING STARTED

1. How does a novel differ from a short story in terms of length, characters, structure, theme, and setting?
2. Study the cover illustration and answer the following questions.
   a. Do you find the cover and title appealing? Why?
   b. What does the title The Giver suggest? How might the meaning of the word 'Giver' connect to the story?
3. Read the blurb and predict what the story will be about.
4. The dedication in the novel says, 'For all the children to whom we entrust the future'. What is the significance of this dedication?

DRAFT

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Lois Lowry was born on March 20, 1937, in Honolulu, Hawaii. She is an American author who has written about 50 books, mainly for young adults, beginning in the 1970s. By the early 1990s, she had solidified her reputation by winning two Newbery Medals, awarded for the most distinguished children's book of the year. On her website, Lowry described the major themes of her books: 'I try, through writing, to convey my passionate awareness that we live intertwined on this planet and that our future depends upon our caring more, and doing more, for one another.'

KEY TERMS

apprehensive: feeling nervous or worried about something that is going to happen

distraught: extremely upset or worried

squinting: looking with partially closed eyes to see something more clearly

intrigued: very interested or curious about something

rasping: harsh or rough in sound

grim: serious/unpleasant, causing a sense of worry or fear

abandoned: left empty/deserted

LEARNING EXPERIENCE

1. Listen to the correct pronunciation and voice modulation, as the teacher reads the section from 'It was almost December…' to '… searched for the right word to describe his own feeling'.

2. Take turns to read aloud the rest of the chapter. As you read, provide and recieve feedback on the correct pronunciation and voice modulation wherever necessary.

3. In pairs, discuss the answers to the following questions.
   a. Which event had frightened Jonas a year before the story begins?
   b. Why was it unusual for an aircraft to fly over the community?
   c. What mistake had the Pilot-in-Training made during the aircraft incident?
   d. What is the nightly family ritual that Jonas's family observes?
   e. Why does Jonas describe his current feeling as 'apprehensive' rather than 'frightened'?

REFLECTION

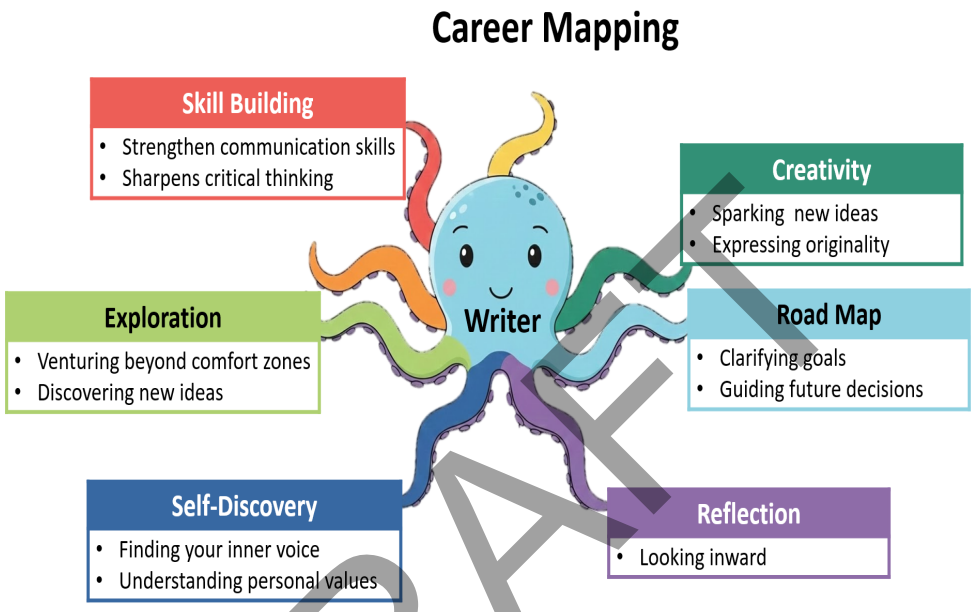
1. Reflect on a occasion when you felt uncomfortable or judged in a new environment. How might your experience help you in demonstrating acceptance and empathy to a newcomer in your school?
2. In Jonas' community, individuals follow instructions without question. How does this make you feel? What are the potentials advantages and disadvantages of such practices?
3. In what ways is your school's setting similar to or different from Jonas' community? Consider aspects such as rules, routines, diversity, and the degree of personal freedom.
4. Have you ever experienced a frightening event, such as an earthquake, landslide, or flood? How did your family or community respond? What does this reveal about Bhutanese resilience?

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Chapters Two and Three

GETTING STARTED

Design a 'Career Mapping' for your future and give reasons. You can either use the example done for you or design a new one.



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KEY TERMS

confided: told someone secret information

fidgeting: making small, restless movements due to nervousness or impatience

squealed: gave a high-pitched cry, often out of excitement/delight

chastisement: a punishment/criticism for misbehavior

hoarded: kept and saved a lot of something, often selfishly or unnecessarily

whimpered: made quiet, low, weak sounds usually from discomfort, fear, or sadness

LEARNING EXPERIENCE

1. Read chapters two and three and complete the tasks below in your groups.
   a. Choose one role from the list: Discussion Director, Connector, Summariser, Literary Luminary, or Plot Tracer.

CONTINUED

b. Use the given table and prepare a short presentation incorporating the responsibilities assigned to your role.

Role	Responsibility
Discussion Director	Write 3 to 4 discussion questions focusing on key events, character decisions, and emotions.
Connector	Identify the chapters' events or characters and connect with your life, other texts, or current events.
Summariser	Write a summary of the chapters.
Literary Luminary	Choose 2 to 3 important quotes or paragraphs from both chapters and explain their significance.
Plot Tracer	Identify the setting and the conflicts in the two chapters.

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c. Take turns to present your discussion. Provide feedback to other groups using the given rubric.

Criteria	Excellent	Good	Satisfactory	Needs Improvement
Role / Responsibility	Completes all role tasks thoroughly, with clear and detailed explanations; provides examples that strongly support ideas.	Completes all role tasks with less detailed explanations; provides examples that support ideas.	Completes role tasks with explanations; provides examples that are not relevant.	Completes role tasks with incorrect explanations and examples.
Connections & Analysis	Explains connections to one's own life, other texts, or current events in a detailed and meaningful way;	Explains connections to one's own life, other texts, or current events in a less detailed way;	Explains connections to one's own life, other texts, or current events, but explanations are unclear;	Explains connections; however, the explanations are incorrect and do not show an understanding

CONTINUED

Connections & Analysis	clearly shows how the connection helps understand the chapter's events, characters, or themes.	shows how the connection relates to the chapter's events, characters, or themes.	shows how the connection relates to the chapter's events, characters, or themes.	of how they relate to the chapter's events, characters, or themes.
Communication & Presentation	Speaks in complete sentences, maintains eye contact, uses a clear voice, and keeps the audience engaged throughout	Speaks in complete sentences, maintains eye contact, uses an audible voice, but does not engage the audience.	Speaks in complete sentences by reading from notes, maintains limited eye contact, and does not engage the audience.	Reads entirely from notes, speaks unclearly, maintains no eye contact, and does not engage the audience.
Collaboration & Participation	Participates in group work, actively shares ideas, responds thoughtfully to the group's contributions, listens carefully, and provides constructive feedback.	Participates in group work, shares ideas, responds to the group, and listens carefully, but feedback is less detailed.	Participates in group work, contributes ideas, listens only when prompted, and feedback shared is not helpful.	Participates in group work but does not share ideas, pay attention, or give helpful feedback.
Use of Language & Vocabulary	Uses new vocabulary and literary terms naturally and accurately in sentences; ideas are clearly expressed with correct grammar and sentence structure.	Uses vocabulary and literary terms correctly; meaning is clear, with minor grammatical or sentence structure errors.	Uses vocabulary or literary terms correctly; sentences confuse meaning due to major grammar or sentence structure errors.	Misuses vocabulary or literary terms; sentences are unclear or difficult to understand.

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REFLECTION

Write a short paragraph to answer the following questions.

1. How is the 'evening telling of feelings' practised in Jonas' family similar to or different from traditions in your family or community?
2. In what ways might this practice help strengthen relationships within the family or the wider community?
3. Would you consider taking time to share your feelings with your family? Why or why not?

Chapters Four and Five

GETTING STARTED

If you were to choose a responsibility or a chore at home, what would it be? How would this freedom of choice make you feel?

KEY TERMS

invariably: always, on every occasion

gravitating: moving naturally toward something

bragging: talking proudly about one's achievements to show off

accomplishment: something achieved successfully through effort

infraction: breaking a rule or law

tunic: a simple, long piece of clothing worn over the body

smock: a protective piece of clothing worn over other clothes while working

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LEARNING EXPERIENCES

1. Read chapters four and five and answer the following questions.

Chapter four

a. Where does Jonas go to complete his volunteer hours?

b. How does Jonas feel about Asher and Fiona as volunteers?

c. In what ways is the House of the Old different from the other community structures?

d. Using the 'Free Frame Story' technique, illustrate how elderly people are treated in both Jonas' and the Bhutanese community.

CONTINUED

Freeze Frame Story

How Elders Are Treated

Procedure:

1. Form groups.
2. Each group creates two frozen poses (tableaus):
   - one showing how elderly people are treated in Jonas's community
   - one showing how elderly people are treated in the Bhutanese community.
3. Groups present their freeze frames to the class, others try to guess which community each tableau represents.

e. Using Jonas' Volunteer Relay, complete the quick challenge.

Jonas' Volunteer Relay

Procedure:

1. Set up stations around the room, each representing one of Jonas's volunteer experiences.
2. At each station, place:
   a. a simple challenge (for example, a mini-puzzle, quick sketch, charade, or any task related to Jonas' volunteer role)
   b. a card describing what Jonas learned from each role.
3. Students form teams.
4. On "Go!", teams go around each station, completing the challenges.
5. After finishing all stations, each team shares one important lesson they think Jonas gained.

Chapter Five

f. What does Jonas' dream about?

g. What are the 'Stirrings', and why is Jonas required to take pills to supress them?

h. How do Jonas' parents respond to his first experience of Stirrings?

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CONTINUED

i. Why is the ritual dream-telling significant in the family? (Students can volunteer to share their recent dreams, while others identify and explain their significance).

j. In Jonas' community, people's emotions and natural desires are controlled through strict rules and medications. Do you believe it is right to prevent people from experiencing these these emotions and feelings? Justify your response.

2. Imagine you are Jonas. Write a diary entry that includes the following points.

   a. your volunteer work experience at the House of the Old

   b. your dream about the first experience of the Stirrings

   c. your thoughts on the upcoming Ceremony of Twelve

REFLECTION

In pairs, discuss how Jonas' experiences at the House of the Old enabled him to develop empathy and a sense of responsibility. Share with your partner how you would incorporate small acts of care and kindness to make an impact on another person's life.

DRAFT

Chapter Six

GETTING STARTED

How do the expectations that families and society have for their children change as they grow into young girls and boys? In what ways do these expectations help children develop a sense of responsibility. responsible?

KEY TERMS

prodded: urged someone to move or take action

emblem: a symbol or an object that symbolises an idea or achievement

stowed: put something away neatly

indulgent: a way or manner that shows gentle approval, leniency, or tolerance

commotion: noisy activity or disturbance

LEARNING EXPERIENCES

1. In pairs, take turns to read aloud chapter six.
2. In groups, identify all the important rules or customs in Jonas' community and write them on a chart paper. Your list may include:
   - clothing based on age
   - ceremony procedures
   - rules on child placement
   - restrictions on becoming attached to temporary new children
   - requirements for volunteering.
3. Select one community rule from the chapter and analyse how it helps in maintaining order within the community. Then design a creative poster that represents the rule and explains its purpose.

REFLECTION

Reflect on your views about arranged marriage and love marriage. Which one would you agree with?

DRAFT

Chapters Seven and Eight

GETTING STARTED

Imagine you are a twelve-year-old child in Jonas' community. You have the option to choose your career from the list: The Giver, The Receiver, Birthmother, Nurturer, Labourer, Caretaker of the Old, Engineer, Instructor, or Recreation Assistant.

1. Which job do you believe would best suit your skills and personality? Explain briefly.
2. How would you feel if a job were assigned to you without your prior knowledge?

KEY TERMS

exasperated: feeling very annoyed or frustrated

tattletale: a person who tells on others for doing something wrong

acquisition: the process of learning or gaining something

piecemeal: done in separate, incomplete parts rather than all at once

crescendo: a gradual increase in intensity, volume, or force

benign: gentle, kind

transgressions: acts of breaking rules or doing something wrong

LEARNING EXPERIENCE

1. Imagine you are Jonas. Write a letter to your parents describing the emotional journey that you experienced during the Ceremony of Twelve. Include the shifts in your moods, such as anticipation ➛ fear ➛ confusion ➛ pride. You may incorporate:
   - your emotions when your number was skipped
   - your confusion and fear upon being selected as the Receiver of Memory
   - your questions or hopes about your training and future role.

2. List the new words from the text, such as meticulous, apprehensive, chastisement, awe, integrity, and capacity. In pairs:
   - find the sentence where the word is used in the chapter
   - find its contextual meaning
   - write a sentence of your own using the word correctly.

   An example is done for you.

   Word: apprehensive

   Textual context: But Jonas was more and more apprehensive as his own turn approached.

   Student sentence: I felt apprehensive before my English test because I had not prepared enough.

DRAFT

REFLECTION

Did your views about the assigned jobs change? How?

Chapter Nine

GETTING STARTED

How would you feel if you were selected for a job that no one else in your community had ever undertaken? Describe the challenges you might face.

KEY TERMS

throng: a large group of people

requisitioned: officially requested or ordered for use

excruciating: extremely painful

steeled: prepared oneself mentally to face something difficult or unpleasant

precision: exactness or accuracy in doing something

DRAFT

LEARNING EXPERIENCE

1. Rank the rules for the Receiver in order of difficulty and justify your choices. In pairs, compare your responses and arrive at a common consensus.

2. If you were Jonas, which rules would:
   a. surprise you
   b. scare you the most
   c. appeal to you the most
   d. sadden you the most
   e. worry you the most?

   Give reasons for your answer.

CONTINUED

3. Frame a set rules for any one of the following job assignments to enable the workers to carry out their duties effectively. Ensure the rules are clear , practical, and enable success in their roles.
   - Nurturer
   - Landscape Worker
   - Caretaker of the Old
   - Assistant Director of Recreation
   - Instructor of Threes.

4. Read the sentences given below to:
   - underline the main and subordinate clauses
   - circle the subordinate clause(s)
   - tick the conjunctions
   - explain the change in meaning caused by punctuation, if any.

   An example is done for you.

Re-reading rule number 6, he realized that a crushed finger fell into the category of "unrelated to training".

DRAFT

Significance of punctuation

1. The comma (,) separates the main clause from the subordinate clause and helps readers pause.
2. The quotation mark (" ") shows that the phrase is directly extracted from the text.
   a. He felt no reaction to rule number 7 at all, for it had never occurred to him that under any circumstances, ever, he might apply for release.
   b. Now, empowered to ask questions of utmost rudeness—and promised answers—he could, conceivably, ask someone, some adult, his father perhaps: 'Do you lie?

CONTINUED

c. He was a little dismayed that his schedule left no time, apparently, for recreation.

d. Once, when he had been a Four, he had said, just prior to the midday meal at school, 'I'm starving.

e. Almost instantly, the excruciating pain in his hand had diminished to the throb which was, now, all he could recall of the experience.

REFLECTION

Write a short paragraph on the extent to which telling lies affects relationships. Elaborate with examples from your experiences or observations.

Chapters Ten and Eleven

GETTING STARTED

Imagine what the Receiver's room might look like. Compare your ideas in your group.

KEY TERMS

upholstered: covered with thick, padded cloth for comfort

alcove: a small recess area or space set back from the main room, used for a bed or furniture

conspicuous: very noticeable/easy to see

embossed: decorated with raised designs/letters pressed onto the surface of a material

deftly: done skillfully and quickly with ease

whirling: spinning or moving around quickly in a circular motion

quizzically: in a puzzled or questioning way

LEARNING EXPERIENCE

1. Choose one question that interests you the most from the given list and form a group with those who have chosen the same question. In your group, discuss and analyse the question and present your group's response to the whole class.

   a. Compare the Giver's room with that of the community's family dwelling units.

DRAFT

CONTINUED

b. Design a comic strip to illustrate the important events and ideas in chapters ten and eleven.

c. Discuss the importance of the first memory (snow) and the second memory (sunshine and sunburn).

d. Discuss the impact of climate control in the community.

e. Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of Jonas' community.

f. Compose a poem, a short story or an essay elaborating Jonas' thoughts and feelings.

2. Read chapters ten and eleven, and in pairs, complete the table given below.

Word	Denotative meaning	Connotative or implied meaning	Example
locked door	secured, not open	secrecy, uniqueness, fear, privilege	No doors in the community were locked, ever.
snow			
sunshine			
sunburn			
downhill			
Receiver			
weighted			
honor			
Elsewhere			

DRAFT

REFLECTION

Imagine living in a community like Jonas's, where there are no weather changes, no hills or natural landscape differences, and no changing seasons. Everything is carefully controlled to remain the same every day. Would you choose to live in such a community? Why or why not?

REVIEW

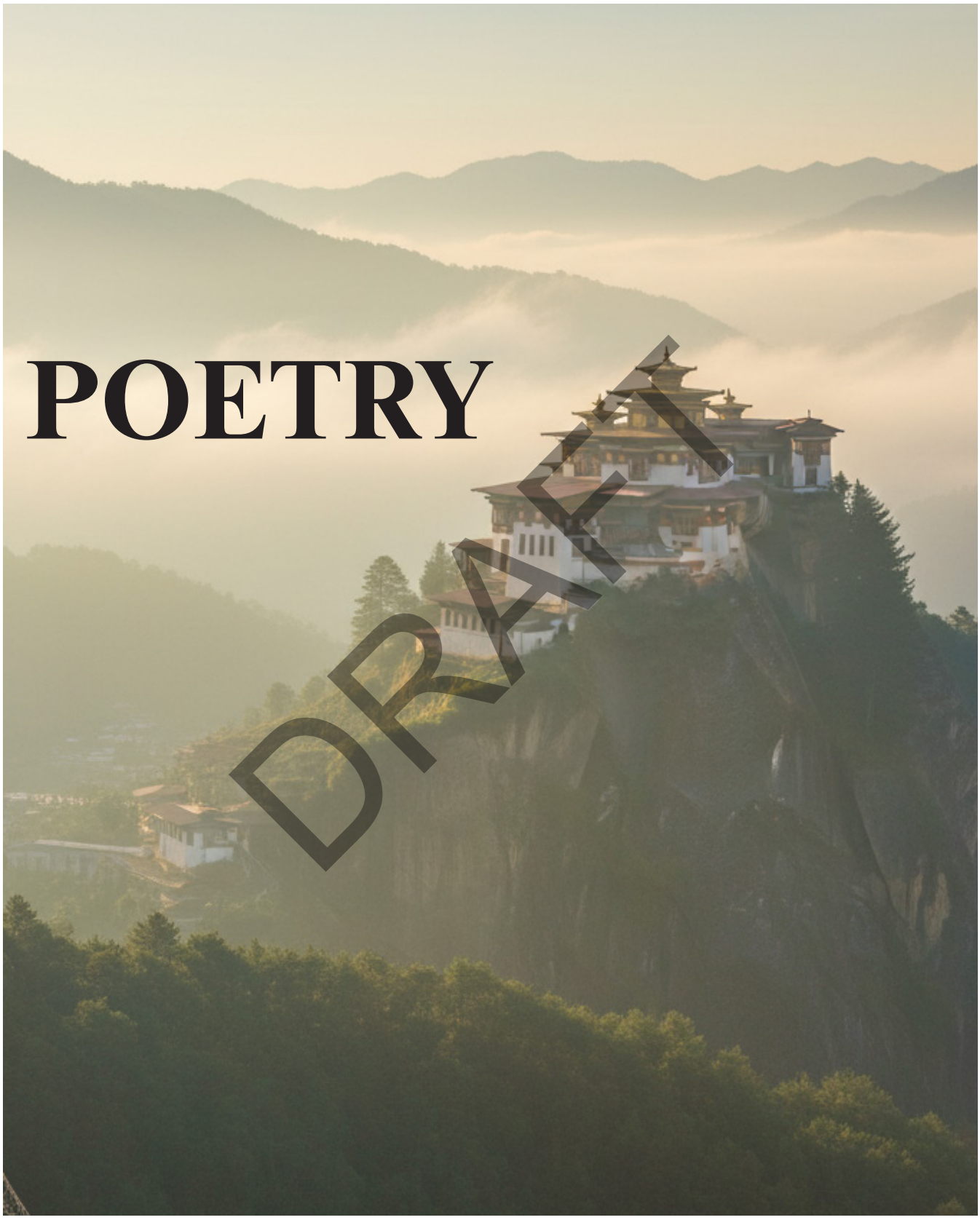
1. In Jonas' community, elderly indiciduals live in the House of Old, while in Bhutan, they are cared for by their family members. Which practice would you prefer to follow in your life? Justify your answer briefly.

2. Compare the community's ritual of 'sharing of feelings' with the ways Bhutanese schools promote of harmony and emotional well-being amongt students

3. Jonas consistently reports his feelings and dreams truthfully, exemplifying integrity. Why is the value of integrity important for Bhutanese youths? Provide one example from your school, home, or community.

4. Why do you think the community controls personal choices, such as your marriage or career? Does this control help maintain the peace and prosperity of society?

DRAFT


POETRY
DRAFT

The Character of a Happy Life

Sir Henry Wotton

didactic lyric poem

GETTING STARTED

1. List all the conditions you believe are essential for a happy and fulfilling life and rank them in order of priority.
2. Compare your list with your partner's and identify the similarities and differences
3. Based on your discussion, write a joint statement describing your shared beliefs about what a 'happy life' means.

DRAFT

How happy is he born and taught
That serveth not another's will;
Whose armour is his honest thought,
And simple truth his utmost skill!
Whose passions not his masters are;
Whose soul is still prepared for death,
Untied unto the world by care
Of public fame or private breath;

Who envies none that chance doth raise,
Nor vice; who never understood
How deepest wounds are given by praise;
Nor rules of state, but rules of good;

Who hath his life from rumours freed;
Whose conscience is his strong retreat;
Whose state can neither flatterers feed,
Nor ruin make oppressors great;

Who God doth late and early pray
More of His grace than gifts to lend;
And entertains the harmless day
With a religious book or friend;

—This man is freed from servile bands
Of hope to rise or fear to fall:
Lord of himself, though not of lands,
And having nothing, yet hath all

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Sir Henry Wotton (1568-1639) was an English poet, diplomat, and statesman best known for his refined wit and elegant verse, including the celebrated poem 'The Character of a Happy Life'. He served as England's ambassador to Venice for many years and later became the Provost of Eton College. Remembered for his scholarship, diplomacy, and literary grace, Wotton remains an important figure of the early 17th-century English Renaissance.

DRAFT

KEY TERMS

rhetorical device: a language technique used by a writer to make language more persuasive, powerful, or effective

conscience: an inner moral guide that helps us choose right from wrong

virtue: a good moral quality in a person, or the general quality of being morally good

vice: immoral or bad habits and behaviour

integrity: having strong moral principles and doing what is right

serveth, hath, doth: archaic (old-fashioned) English words; serveth: serves, hath: has, doth:does

parallelism: the use of similar grammatical structures for a series of related words, phrases, or clauses to create balance and emphasise ideas of equal importance

LEARNING EXPERIENCE

1. Recite the poem with correct pronunciation, enunciation, and rhythm. (You may choose to record your poem recitation as an audio for homework or project work.)
2. Discuss and write answers to the following questions.
   a. Identify the rhetorical devices used in the poem and provide examples.
   b. Using examples from the text, explain the concept of virtue and praise.
   c. Choose a line from the text that resonated with you and explain how it influenced your thoughts or feelings.

CONTINUED

d. If you had to tell a friend what the poem is about, how would you explain its key messages?

e. Connect the key themes of the poem to the core principles of Gross National Happiness(GNH), and explain your resaonsings.

3. Revise the relative pronouns learnt in your previous classes, and carry out the following activities.

a. Identify the relative pronoun and the relative clause in each lines below.

i. 'Who serveth not another's will'

ii. 'Whose armour is his honest thought'

iii. 'Whose soul is still prepared for death'

iv. 'Who envies none that chance doth raise'

v. 'Whose conscience is his strong retreat'

b. Rewrite each line as a complete sentence by adding a suitable subject, keeping the relative clause unchanged. An example is done for you.

Example:

Line: '**Who** God doth late and early pray'

Rewrite: A person who prays to God late and early.

i. 'Whom everyone trusted during difficult times'

ii. 'Whose honesty inspires everyone'

iii. 'Which shines brightly in the morning sun'

iv. 'That survived the powerful storm'

v. 'Where children gather to read and play'

vi. 'When the entire village celebrates together'

DRAFT

CONTINUED

4. Read the poem and carry out the following tasks.
    a. Identify the lines in the poem that use parallel structure. For example, 'Of hope to rise or fear to fall'.
    b. Complete the given phrases by using the parallel pattern.
        i. *Of success to gain or* _____
        ii. *Having wisdom, but* _____
        iii. *Free from anger, and* _____
    c. Write two sentences using parallelism that reflect the style of the poem.

REFLECTION

1. What thoughts, feelings, or experiences come to mind when you think about a happy life?
2. Do you think Sir Wotton's idea of a happy life is attainable in the 21st century? Why or why not?

EXPLORE FURTHER

1. *If* by Rudyard Kipling

DRAFT

Buddha's Death

Romesh Chunder Dutt

narrative poem

GETTING STARTED

1. What do you know about Buddha's life and his journey toward enlightenment?
2. How are his teachings reflected in the way Bhutanese people live, in general?



DRAFT

I

Thus in many lands they wandered,
Buddha and his faithful friend,
Teaching truth to many nations,
Till his life approached its end.
And they say, along the pathway,
As the saintly Master went,
Fruit trees blossomed out of season
And a lovely fragrance lent!
And that flowers and sandal-powder
Gently fell on him from high,
And came strains of heavenly music
Gently wafted from the sky!

II

But the saintly Master whispered
To his friend beloved and blest,
'Tis not thus, O friend Ananda!
That the Buddha's honoured best.
Not by flowers or sandal-powder,
Not by music's heavenly strain,
Is the soul's true worship rendered,
Useless are these things and vain!
But the brother and the sister,
Man devout and woman holy,___
Pure in life, in duty faithful,__
They perform the worship truly!

III

Night came on, and saintly Buddha
Slept in suffering, sick and wan,
When a Brahman, seeking wisdom,
Came to see the holy man.
Anxiously Ananda stopped him.
But spoke Buddha, though in pain,
"He who comes to seek for wisdom
Shall not come to me in vain!"
And he to the pious stranger
Told the truth, in language plain,
Taught the law with dying accents,
Stopped and never spoke again!

DRAFT

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Romesh Chunder Dutt (1848 -1909) was an Indian civil servant, economic historian, translator, and writer whose scholarship and public service made him a leading figure of late-19th-century Bengal. He is best known for his works on India's economic history and for his English verse condensations of the Ramayana and Mahabharata.

KEY TERMS

biodiversity: contrast: to compare two people or things to show their differences

symbolism: using objects or events to represent deeper ideas

strain: soft, gentle musical notes or melodies

wan: pale, weak, or showing signs of illness and exhaustion

pious: deeply religious, spiritual, or devoted to doing what is morally right

Brahman: a member of the priestly Hindu caste; a learned person

LEARNING EXPERIENCE

1. Listen carefully as the teacher reads the poem aloud. Then, read the poem yourself with clear enunciation and proper intonation.

2. Write responses to each question below.
   a. List words that describe the speaker's attitude.
   b. Which specific lines, phrases, or words in the poem reveal the tone and create the mood?
   c. Identify the literary devices used in the poem and support your answer with examples from the text.
   d. Why do you think the Buddha says that the offering of flowers and music 'useless and vain'?
   e. What lesson does the line, 'He who comes to seek wisdom / Shall not come to me in vain' convey? How will you apply it in your life?
   f. What are the main themes of 'Buddha's Death,' and how are they portrayed in the poem?
   g. Does the poem suggest that the Buddha transcends death, or does it imply that he ceases to exist? Explain your reasoning with evidence from the poem.
   h. According to the Buddha, what should people do to 'perform and worship truly'?

3. Choose one stanza for your group and identify the characters, their roles, and the setting. Dramatise the stanza.

DRAFT

CONTINUED

4. Revise types of adverbs and discuss with your teacher how adverbs modify verbs and adjectives. Then, read the poem and identify the sentences that contain adverbs. Write them correctly under the appropriate type in the table below. An example is done for you.

adverb of manner	adverb of time	adverb of place	adverb of degree	adverb of frequency
Anxiously, Ananda stopped him.	**Night** came on…	**Along** the pathway…		**Till** his life approached its end

REFLECTION

1. Using Bhutanese values of tha-damtse lay-judray, reflect on what you believe makes life meaningful and worthwhile.
2. How might embracing Buddha's teachings transform your perspective on life and influence your daily choices?

EXPLORE FURTHER

Desiderata by Max Ehrmann

DRAFT

The Road Not Taken

Robert Frost

narrative lyric

GETTING STARTED

With your shoulder partner, talk about a time when you faced a dilemma of having to choose one option over another. What did you choose, and why? Do you regret not choosing the other option? Why?



DRAFT

Two roads diverged in a yellow wood,
And sorry I could not travel both
And be one traveller, long I stood
And looked down one as far as I could
To where it bent in the undergrowth;

Then took the other, as just as fair,
And having perhaps the better claim,
Because it was grassy and wanted wear;
Though as for that the passing there
Had worn them really about the same,

And both that morning equally lay
In leaves no step had trodden black.
Oh, I kept the first for another day!

Yet knowing how way leads on to way,
I doubted if I should ever come back.

I shall be telling this with a sigh
Somewhere ages and ages hence:
Two roads diverged in a wood, and I__
I took the one less travelled by,
And that has made all the difference.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Robert Frost (1874-1963) was born in San Francisco but moved to New England at the age of eleven. He became interested in reading and writing poetry during his high school years in Lawrence, Massachusetts. Frost was influenced by contemporary poets of his time, like Edward Thomas, Rupert Brooke, and Robert Graves. By the 1920s, he was the most celebrated poet in America. With each new book, including 'New Hampshire', 'A Further Range', 'Steeple Bush', and 'In the Clearing', his fame and honours (including four Pulitzer Prizes) continued to grow. Frost is considered a quintessentially modern poet for his use of natural, conversational language, the psychological complexity of his character portrayal, and the rich layers of ambiguity and irony infused in his work.

DRAFT

KEY TERMS

rhyme scheme: the pattern of end sounds in a poem

diverged: split into two directions

yellow wood: a forest with yellow leaves in autumn

wanted wear: not used much

trodden: walked on

sigh: deep breath showing thought or feeling

ages and ages hence: far, far in the future

LEARNING EXPERIENCE

1. Read the poem aloud and underline the last word of each line. Assign letters to rhyming sounds (A,B, C…) to words with the same rhyming sounds to identify the rhyming scheme in each stanza. Why do you think the poet chose this rhyming pattern?

CONTINUED

2. In your group, take one stanza each. Discuss and present on the following questions:
   a. What does the speaker want to convey in the stanza?
   b. How does the use of literary devices enhance the meaning of the stanza?

3. Write responses to the questions below:
   a. Explain the theme of the poem in at least two paragraphs prividing examples from your life.
   b. Why do you think the speaker repeats the idea of two roads?
   c. Interpret the literal and the figurative meanings of the following phrases
      - 'way leads on to way'
      - 'Two roads diverged in a wood'.
      - 'I took the one less travelled by, /And that has made all the difference,'
   d. What do the roads symbolise in the poem?
   e. Justify whether the speaker is happy with the choice he made.

4. Debate on the statement: Choosing your own path leads to greater success than following others.

DRAFT

REFLECTION

Think of a time when you had to make an important choice. Reflect on the situation and write a short narrative essay describing the choice you had to make, the result of your choice, and the lesson you learned from the experience.

EXPLORE FURTHER

The Journey by Mary Oliver

I Know Why the Caged Bird Sings

Maya Angelou

free verse

GETTING STARTED

Look closely at the given image and write three words to describe the birds flying in the air and the bird in the cage. Explain what the caged and free birds might symbolise. Then, discuss your ideas and words with your face partner to create a strong, vivid description of each bird. Share your descriptions with the class.



DRAFT

A free bird leaps
on the back of the wind
and floats downstream
till the current ends
and dips his wings
in the orange sun rays
and dares to claim the sky.

But a bird that stalks
down his narrow cage
can seldom see through
his bars of rage
his wings are clipped and

his feet are tied
so he opens his throat to sing.

The caged bird sings
with fearful trill
of the things unknown
but longed for still
and his tune is heard
on the distant hill for the caged bird
sings of freedom.

The free bird thinks of another breeze
and the trade winds soft through the sighing trees
and the fat worms waiting on a dawn-bright lawn
and he names the sky his own.

But a caged bird stands on the grave of dreams
his shadow shouts on a nightmare scream
his wings are clipped and his feet are tied
so he opens his throat to sing.

The caged bird sings
with a fearful trill
of things unknown
but longed for still
and his tune is heard
on the distant hill
for the caged bird
sings of freedom.

DRAFT

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Maya Angelou (1928–2014) was an American poet, writer, and civil rights activist. Born in St. Louis and raised in Arkansas, she grew up during a time of racial segregation. Her best-known work is the autobiography 'I Know Why the Caged Bird Sings',which tells the story of her childhood and her resilience in overcoming hardships. Angelou wrote numerous poems and books that explore themes of identity, freedom, and courage. She received several national honours, including the Presidential Medal of Freedom. Her powerful words continue to inspire people around the world.

KEY TERMS

trill: a musical, vibrating sound made by a voice or bird, often high and trembling

extended metaphor: a metaphor that continues through multiple lines or an entire poem

allusion: a reference to a historical, cultural, or social idea without naming it

paradox: a statement that seems contradictory but reveals a truth

oppression: an unfair or cruel treatment that limits a person's rights or abilities

free verse: poetry whose lines do not have a regular pattern

LEARNING EXPERIENCE

1. Carefully read the poem, paying close attention to its tone. If you have access to internet, listen to Maya Angelou read the poem on YouTube (https://youtu.be/ZwKsjTVhfcU?si=UryyqJeUVEDQabyZ).



2. Recite the poem, paying attention to stress, rhythm, intonation, and emotional expression.
3. In groups, assign the roles of the caged bird, the free bird, and the narrator. While the narrator reads the poem aloud with expression, the birds should act out expressing their feelings and actions accordingly. After the role play, discuss and answer the following questions.
   a. What does the free bird represent?
   b. What does the caged bird represent?
   c. Why do you think the caged bird sings, but the free bird does not?
   d. What images or ideas come to mind when you read the phrases 'bars or rage' and 'grave of dreams'?
4. Answer the questions below.
   a. Identify the literary devices used in the poem, and explain how they help you to understand the feelings and experiences of both the free and the caged bird.

DRAFT

CONTINUED

b. List examples from the poem where the caged bird experiences unfair treatment or restrictions. Discuss how these experiences impact its voice and freedom.

c. Explain how the poem uses the 'caged bird' and 'free bird' as extended metaphors. Discuss how these metaphors continue throughout the poem.

d. Find and explain lines that reflect social, historical, or cultural issues such as social inequality, and the fight for freedom.

e. What are the main themes of the poem? Describe how Maya Angelou presents these themes through the contrasting experiences of the free and the caged birds.

f. Recall a time when you felt restricted like the 'caged bird'. Why did this situation happen, and how did you overcome it? What did you learn from the experience?

5. Imagine that the caged bird is speaking to you. Write a letter in reply, showing empathy and expressing your thoughts, feelings, or advice you wish to share with the bird.

REFLECTION

1. How does the poem reflect issues of inequality, unfairness, or oppression in your community, country, or the world?
2. Do you find any similarities between the caged bird's experience and your own ?

EXPLORE FURTHER

Sympathy by Paul Laurence Dunbar

DRAFT

REVIEW

1. Choose the most appropriate answer from the choices given under each question.

   a. What do the two roads mainly symbolise in 'The Road Not Taken'?

      i. two paths

      ii. two different seasons

      iii. choices and decisions

      iv. a journey into the forest

   b. According to the poem 'The Character of a Happy Life', a happy person is the one who

      i. can create wealth.

      ii. can please everyone.

      iii. gives up all responsibilities.

      iv. is virtuous, honest, and free from envy.

   c. A repeated sound at the beginning of words is called

      i. rhyme.

      ii. repetition.

      iii. assonance.

      iv. alliteration.

   d. In 'The Road Not Taken', the speaker's tone at the end of the poem appears to be

      i. angry.

      ii. confused.

      iii. regretful.

      iv. thoughtful.

DRAFT

REVIEW

e. What is the rhyme scheme of 'The Road Not Taken'?

i. ABAB

ii. ABAAB

iii. AABB

iv. Free verse

f. Which poem that you have studied uses free verse?

i. The Road Not Taken

ii. Buddha's Death

iii. I Know Why the Caged Bird Sings

iv. The Character of a Happy Life

2. Fill in the table with the key theme(s) against each poem

Poem	Key Theme / Idea
The Character of a Happy Life	
Buddha's Death	
The Road Not Taken	
I Know Why the Caged Bird Sings	

3. Write answers for each question given below:
   a. Which poem reflects important Bhutanese values such as contentment, mindfulness, and happiness? Support your answer with lines from the poem.
   b. Review the figures of speech you have learnt in the poetry section and write examples as shown below.
   Metaphor: 'Two roads diverged in a yellow wood',

4. Choose any two poems. Compare and contrast them in terms of form, structure, and theme.
5. What are the key features of a free verse poem? List and briefly explain at least three features.
6. Write a three-stanza poem expressing what freedom means to you. Use a variety of literary devices.

DRAFT


DRAFT
Short Stories

A Grain of Mustard Seed

Edith Pargeter

realistic fiction

GETTING STARTED

Read the title of the story and answer.

1. What comes to your mind when you read the title 'A Grain of Mustard Seed'?
2. Discuss the following in pairs.

   a. similarities and differences between India and Pakistan in terms of language and culture

   b. your experiences or events where people helped each other without any expection

When I was a little girl in Lahore, my father had a friend who was a Muslim. Indeed, he had many, but Mahdar Iqbal was a special one. He was the shoemaker who used to make our sandals. When we first knew him, he was heavily in debt, but my father began to throw business his way, and tell our friends about him, and gradually he was able to pay off his debts, and even to save a little. He had only a poor booth in the doorway of his house, and his dream was to have a shop in the bazaar. By the time of the troubles, he had more than fifteen hundred rupees saved up towards it, so he told my father.

In appearance these two men were not unlike; both thin, bright, active men, but my father's slenderness was small-boned and frail, and Mahdar Iqbal's was sinewy and tough as his own leather. Two or three times a week I'd see them bent over the chessboard in the cool corner of my father's shop—he was a jeweller, and we were quite well off in those days—putting the whole world right. One thing they had in common was that they both believed it was possible.

It was my father who taught me, also, to believe that god was universal and benevolent, and man was perfectible, and by his very origin, disposed to good. I adored him, so naturally, I took his word for it.

The bad days were already coming upon us then. In Lahore, when partition came, the hate burst out from nowhere and overwhelmed everything. We dared not go out in the streets at all. Our shop and house were looted and burnt down. They left us a roof at least, and there we stayed in hiding, and thought now only of getting away back to India. It was very strange for us; Lahore was no longer India.

DRAFT

Class IX English Textbook A Grain of Mustard Seed

My father suffered, perhaps, more than most of our people, because all his ideas about men were being broken in pieces, one by one, and kicked into the dust. At first he would not believe that this hatred and unreason could go on, and he would not run before it. But in the end, it was plain that we must run or die.

Those of our people who had left in good time had been able to take some of their possessions with them. By the time we set our minds on leaving, we had nothing left to take but the clothes we stood in, and by then, too, it seemed that we might not be able to leave at all. But at last they said that a train would be allowed to leave on a certain day; but no one was permitted to take anything of value.

On the morning when the tram was to leave, we crept out of the shell of our house, and went to the railway station. The streets were full of Muslims, decent people who had been our neighbours, all screaming threats at us, spitting at us, even throwing stones as we hurried by. It was on my mother we leaned on then; she had never thought as highly of her fellow men as my father had, and therefore she was not so terribly hurt as he was; she could hate them back, and he could not.

On the platform, the crowd broke through the barrier and ran after us. And suddenly, I saw Mahdar Iqbal's face among them. We had not seen him for weeks; no one dared move about normally, or go near his friends. I saw the flare of hope that brightened the wreckage of my father's face, for one meaningful glance exchanged with Mahdar Iqbal could at least save something for him.

And Mahdar Iqbal shoved his way through the press, flung himself upon my father, and shook him savagely by the shoulders.

'Dog of a Hindu!' he yelled into his face, 'Let's see what you've got there in your pockets! Let's see what you're stealing from us!'

He plunged his hands into my father's pockets and turned out everything he had there: his handkerchief, his spectacle case, the fragments he had left from a life, all the time raving and reviling him like a madman.

My father stood like a dead creature, and let himself be mishandled. The man who had been his friend pawed over the last of his possessions disgustedly, spat his contempt on the ground, and laughed, bundling the poor bits back again.

'Go, then, and get fat on it! Take your pocketful of garbage home with you!' he shouted. And he took my father by the shoulders and threw him into the train, so roughly, that he stumbled and fell.

My mother thrust me in after him, and put herself between me and the rush of people that suddenly welled down the train, beating at the slatted windows and yelling curses at us. The last I ever saw of Mahdar Iqbal, he was standing on the platform with a demon's grin on his face, shaking a fist at us. But we were in the train, we had a corner to crouch in, a wall at our backs.

We were lucky enough—is that the word?—to escape with nothing worse than my father's broken glasses and broken heart.

People died in the train, too, before we reached Amritsar. We were crushed together so that we could scarcely move. And that was terrible, to be welded to my father's side like a piece of his very flesh, and to know that he was not there with me at all, but somewhere a long way off, and quite alone.

'What did you expect?' my mother said to him, sounding angry. 'Could he fold you in his arms, and wish you a safe journey? He has a wife and children to consider, just as much as you.'

My father sat with his broken glasses sagging on his nose, and stared at nothing.

'I know he could not come to me with his blessing', he said. 'But could he not be content with holding off from me. Why was it necessary to lay hands on me in unkindness? Was he forced to do me violence?'

'He had to show himself a good Muslim,' said my mother bitterly, 'and good Muslims hate us. It is not enough not to love us. He wanted to show how utterly he had cut us off. Do you think they don't know he used to visit us?'

'He could have put that out of mind better,' said my father, with quiet, hopeless certainty, 'by staying out of sight, not by running to be the first to humiliate me. No, he is gone mad with hate, like all the world.'

And after a while of silence he said, in that soft, distant, haunting voice, 'I would not have claimed him. He need not have come near me. One look of kindness would have been enough. I could have lived on that, simply knowing he was as he had always been.'

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My mother, because she was frightened, began to abuse him a little, saying that there were still good men in the world; but I knew she did not really believe it. If hatred could destroy Mahdar Iqbal, it could destroy every man.

My father turned his face to the wall. And in a moment I heard him say in a cold voice: 'Man is irreclaimable. There is no hope for him. And God does not care.'

I had been listening to every word that he uttered, and I could understand what he meant. But he had taught me so well that I could not believe what he was now telling me.

If God did not care, then why had Lord Vishnu entered the world nine times already to help his people? Why had Christ come to be among men and suffer? Why did the Bodhisattva turn his back on the perfect bliss of Nirvana and return to the world to show men the way by which they could enter and share enlightenment? Why should God—all the aspects of God in all the world—spend so much time on the reclamation of man if man was irreclaimable? Who would know it better than he? My heart told me it could not be true.

It seemed to me that if I really had faith, it ought to be possible to turn this experience inside out, to find in it the fallacy that quite altered its meaning, and would restore my father to life. So I made up a very short and pointed prayer within my mind, and said it to God.

'Please consider, God,' I said to him reasonably, 'that I am only a little girl, and you can't leave it all to me. I know I'm right, I know the proof is there, but I don't know how to find it. Please take my hand and lead me to whatever it is I need, or else my father will surely die.'

I didn't expect anything to happen at once, and nothing happened. I didn't mind that. I had taken action in declaring myself, and that is always a liberating thing to do. The oppression seemed to lift from me at once, I even felt cooler.

I looked again at my father, and I saw that there were tears streaming down his cheeks. We were so crushed he could not get his hand to the pocket of his achkan to pull out his handkerchief. But my hand was smaller and already folded into the hollow of his side, and by wriggling patiently, I got my fingers into the opening, and drew out a corner of the handkerchief between them.

And something else came out with it, a tight little roll screwed into a square of tissue. It rolled into my father's lap, and the wrapping parted; we saw the crumpled edges of a number of banknotes slowly uncoiling, and a scrap of white paper in the heart of the roll.

My mother instinctively put out her hand to cover all that money from sight.

My father had taken up the scrap of paper in a trembling hand, and was staring from that to the banknotes as though he had been shocked back into life by the certainty that he was going mad.

'But it is impossible! I had no money. I had nothing, I swear. Where did this come from?'

But I knew! I pressed my cheek close to his shoulder, and gasped into his ear: 'Don't you see? Don't you understand? Who put his hands into your pockets, turned out all your belongings, and then pushed everything back in again?'

'Mahdar Iqbal!' he breathed, and stared at the money; but I knew it was not the money that was bringing back feeling and form and meaning into his face. 'Read the note,' said my mother urgently.

It was as he read it through for the first time, silently, that he became in his essence the man he had always been, and a little nearer, surely, to being indestructible. And when he read it the second time, aloud, he was already a little less and a little more than he had always been. A little less by not being able to make amends, a little more by accepting humbly his eternal disability.

'Forgive me,' he read, 'but there is no other way of getting this to you. If I spoke with you as a friend, both you and I would be torn to pieces. Take in kindness to me what you now need so much more than I. Forgive me, and remember me not as I am to you today, but as I shall be to you always in spirit. I shall never know a better man.'

There were more than fifteen hundred rupees in the roll of notes. Mahdar Iqbal had given us everything he had.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Edith Pargeter was born in 1913 at Horsehay, Shropshire. She attended Dawley Church of England School and the Coalbrookdale High School for Girls. During World War II, she worked in an administrative role with the Women's Royal Navy Service in Liverpool and was awarded the British Empire Medal. She published several novels during this period, including 'Ordinary People' (1941) and 'She Goes to War' (1942), the latter of which drew on her wartime experiences.

Pargeter later became internationally known under the pen name Ellis Peters, winning awards from the British Crime Writers' Association and the Mystery Writers of America. After her death in October 1995, The Times published a full obituary that declared that here was 'a deeply sensitive and perceptive woman...an intensely private and modest person' whose writing was 'direct, even a little stilted, matching a self-contained personality.'

Class IX English Textbook A Grain of Mustard Seed

KEY TERMS

benevolent: kind, caring

overwhelmed: completely overcome

savagely: in a cruel or harsh way

reviling: shouting insults or speaking very angrily

reclamation: the act of saving or restoring something that seems lost or damaged

oppression: a feeling of being weighed down by fear, sadness, or cruelty

LEARNING EXPERIENCE

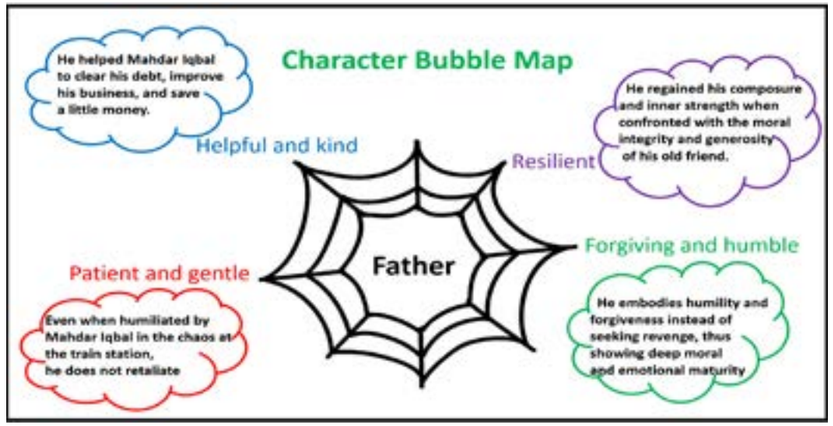
1. Read the story independently and answer the following questions.
   a. Who is the narrator of the story?
   b. Why did the narrator's father help Mahdar Iqbal?
   c. What are the similarities between the two men?
   d. Why did the family decide to leave Lahore?
   e. Why did the narrator say that her father suffered more than others?
   f. Describe Mahdar Iqbal's behaviour at the train station.

2. In pairs, discuss the interpretations for the following statements.
   a. '...my father began to throw business his way...'
   b. 'Putting the whole world right'.
   c. 'I took his word for it'.
   d. '…we crept out of the shell of our house
   e. 'I would not have claimed him'.

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CONTINUE

2. In groups, develop a character sketch for all the characters using the Character Bubble Map activity and explain each character trait. An example is done for you.



4. Discuss the following questions in pairs.
   a. Did the ending of the story surprise you? How?
   b. Do you think forgiveness is possible after betrayal?
   c. How does the author create sympathy for both sides of the conflict?
   d. Explain your response to Mahdar Iqbal's actions at the train station, in reference to his actions, intentions, and the consequences. .
   e. How does the narrator's young age affect our trust in her account of events?
   f. What does the story teach about faith and forgiveness?

5. In your group, discuss the plot of the story including themes and values.

6. Write a short paragraph explaining how communities with different faiths can live together in peace and harmony, incorporating the following grammar and language structures.
   - expressing opinion: I believe that…/ In my opinion…/ It seems that…

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CONTINUED

- cause and effect: because / therefore / as a result / so that…
- reported speech for expressing viewpoint: He said that…/ She felt that…
- adjectives for character traits: compassionate, naive, bitter, remorseful, loyal, just, unjust.

7. Using the context of the story, write one adapted example sentence for each conditional type. or each sentence, include:
   - conditional type (zero, first, second, and third)
   - rule
   - explanation (explain how the conditional is used in your sentence.)

One example has been done for you.

- adapted sentence: If we run before the violence, we will survive.
- conditional type: conditional type 1
- rule: If + present simple, … will + base verb
- explanation: This refers to the urgent need for the narrator's family to escape from Lahore. It reflects the real, immediate consequences of inaction during Partition.

REFLECTION

Create a short (1–2 minute) video clip or write a short reflection from the narrator's perspective, explaining how her view of people changed after the incident at the train station.

EXPLORE FURTHER

The Sniper by Liam O'Flaherty

DRAFT

I've Got Gloria

M.E Kerr

contemporary realistic fiction

GETTING STARTED

1. Have you ever blamed someone for a mistake which was actually yours?
2. What would happen if we avoid taking responsibility for our mistakes? Share your experiences with the class.

"I've got Gloria."

"Oh, thank heaven! Is she all right?"

"She's fine, Mrs.Whitman."

"Where is she?"

"She's here with me."

"Who are you?"

"You can call me Bud."

"Bud who?"

"Never mind that, Mrs. Whitman. I've got your little dog and she's anxious to get back home."

"Oh, I know she is. She must miss me terribly. Where are you? I'll come and get her right away."

"Not so fast, Mrs. Whitman. First, there's a little something you must do."
"Anything. Just tell me where to find you."

"I' ll find you, Mrs. Whitman, after you do as I say."

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"What do you mean, Bud?"

"I mean that I'll need some money before I get Gloria home safely to you."

"Money?"

"She's a very valuable dog."

"Not really. I got her from the pound."

"But she's valuable to you, isn't she?"

"She's everything to me."

"So you have to prove it, Mrs. Whitman."

"What is this?"

"A dognapping. I have your dog and you have to pay to have her returned safely to you."

There was a pause.

I could just imagine her face—that face I hated ever since she flunked me. That mean, freckled face, with the glasses over those hard little green eyes, the small, pursed lips, the mop of frizzy red hair topping it all... Well, top this, Mrs. Whitman: I do not even have that nutsy little bulldog of yours. She is lost, just as your countless signs nailed up everywhere announce that she is... All I have is this one chance to get revenge, and I'm grabbing it!

Now her voice came carefully. "How much do you want?"

"A thousand dollars, Mrs. Whitman. A thou, in one-hundred-dollar bills, and Gloria will be back drooling on your lap."

"A thousand dollars?"

"Got to you, didn't I? Did your stomach turn over the way mine did when I saw that F in math?"

"You heard me, Mrs. Whitman."

"Are you one of my students?"

"Oh, like I'm going to tell you if I am."

"You must be."

"I could be, couldn't I? You're not everyone's dream teacher, are you?"

"Please, don't hurt my dog."

"I'm not cruel by nature."

I don't take after my old man. He said he was sorry that I flunked math because he knew how much I was counting on the hike through Yellow-stone this summer. He said maybe the other guys would take some photos so I could see what I was missing while I went to summer school to get a passing grade. "Gee, Scott," he said, "what a shame, and now you won't get an allowance, either, or have TV in your bedroom, or the use of the computer. But never mind, sonny boy," he said, "there'll be lots to do around the house. I'll leave lists for you every day of things to be done before I get home."

Mrs. Whitman whined, "I just don't have a thousand dollars. I don't know where I'll get so much money, either."

Sometimes I whined that way, and my mom would say, "Scotty, we wouldn't be so hard on you if you'd only take responsibility for your actions. We tell you to be in at eleven p.m. and you claim the bus was late. We ask you to take the tapes back to Videoland and you say we never said to do it. You always have an excuse for everything! You never blame yourself!"

"Mrs. Whitman? I don't mean to be hard on you but that's the deal, see. A thou in hundreds."

"Just don't hurt Gloria."

"Gee, what a shame that you have to worry about such a thing. She's a sweet little dog, and I know she misses you because she's not eating."

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"She doesn't eat dog food, Bud. I cook for her."

"That's why she doesn't eat, hmm? I don't know how to cook."

"You could just put a frozen dinner in the microwave. A turkey dinner, or a Swanson's pot roast. I'll pay you for it."

"A thousand dollars plus ten for frozen dinners? Is that what you're suggesting?"

"Let me think. Please. I have to think how I can get the money."

"Of course, you do. I'll call you back, Mrs. Whitman, and meanwhile I'll go to the store and get some Swanson's frozen dinners."

"When will you "

I hung up.

I could hear Dad coming up the stairs.

"Scott?"

"Yes, sir?"

"I'm going to take the car in for an oil change. I want you to come with me."

"I have some homework, sir."

"I want you to come with me. Now."

In the car, he said, "We need to talk."

"About what?" I said.

There was one of her Lost Dog signs tacked to the telephone pole at the end of our street.

"We need to talk about this summer," he said.

"What about it?"

"You have to make up the math grade. That you have to do. I'm sorry you can't go to Yellowstone."

"Yeah."

"There's no other way if you want to get into any kind of college. Your other grades are fine. But you need math... What's so hard about math, Scott?"

"I hate it!"

"I did, too, but I learned it. You have to study."

"Mrs. Whitman doesn't like me."

"Why doesn't she like you?"

"She doesn't like anyone but that bulldog."

"Who's lost, apparently."

"Yeah."

"The signs are everywhere."

"Yeah."

"But she wouldn't deliberately flunk you, would she?"

"Who knows?"

"Do you really think a teacher would flunk you because she doesn't like you?"

"Who knows?"

"Scott, you've got to admit when you're wrong. I'll give you an example. I was wrong when I said you couldn't have an allowance or TV or use of the computer, et cetera. I was angry and I

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just blew! That was wrong. It wouldn't have made it any easier for you while you're trying to get a passing grade in math. So I was wrong! I apologize and I take it back."

"How come?"

"How come? Because I'm sorry. I thought about it and it bothered me. I'm a hothead, and I don't like that about myself. Okay?"

"Yeah."

"Maybe that's what's wrong here."

"What's wrong where?"

"Between us."

"Is something wrong between us?"

"Scotty, I'm trying to talk with you. About us. I want to work things out so we get along better."

"Yeah."

"Sometimes I do or say rash things."

"Yeah."

"I always feel lousy after."

"Oh, yeah?"

"Do you understand? I shouldn't take things out on you. That's petty. Life is hard enough. We don't have to be mean and spiteful with each other. Agreed?"

"Yeah." I was thinking about the time our dog didn't come home one night. I couldn't sleep. I even prayed. When he got back all muddy the next morning, I broke into tears and told him,

"Now you're making me blubber like a baby!"

Dad was still on my case.

"Scott, I want you to think about why Mrs. Whitman flunked you."

"I just told you: she doesn't like me."

"Are you really convinced that you're good at math but the reason you failed was because she doesn't like you?"

"Maybe."

"Is she a good teacher?"

"She never smiles. She's got these tight little lips and these ugly freckles."

"So she's not a good teacher?"

"I can't learn from her."

"Did you study hard?"

"I studied. Sure. I studied."

"How many others flunked math?"

"What?"

"How many others flunked math?"

"No one."

"Speak up."

"I said, I'm the only one."

"So others learn from her despite her tight little lips and ugly freckles?"

"I guess."

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Class IX English Textbook I've Got Gloria

"Scott, who's to blame for your flunking math?"

"Okay," I said. "Okay."

"Who is to blame?"

"Me. Okay? I didn't study that hard."

He sighed and said, " There. Good. You've accepted the blame...How do you feel?"

"I feel okay." I really didn't, though. I was thinking about that dumb bulldog running loose somewhere, and about Mrs. Whitman worried sick now that she thought Gloria'd been dognapped.

Dad said, "I think we both feel a lot better."

We sat around in the waiting room at the service centre.

Dad read Sports Illustrated, but I couldn't concentrate on the magazines there or the ballgame on TV. I was down. I knew what Dad meant when he'd told me he felt bad after he "blew" and that he didn't like himself for it.

I kept glancing toward the pay phone. I stuck my hands in my pants pockets. I had a few quarters.

"I'm going to call Al and see what he's doing tonight," I said.

Dad said, "Wait until you get home. We'll be leaving here very shortly."

"I'm going to look around," I said.

I didn't know Mrs. Whitman's number. I'd copied it down from one of the Lost Dog signs and ripped it up after I'd called her. I hadn't planned to follow up the call, get money from her: nothing like that. I just wanted to give her a good scare.

I went over to the phone book and looked her up.

Then I ducked inside the phone booth, fed the slot a quarter, and dialled.

"Hello?"

"Mrs. Whitman? I don't have your dog. I was playing a joke."

"I know you don't have my dog. Gloria's home. The dog warden found her and brought her back right after you hung up on me."

I was relieved. At least she wouldn't have to go all night worrying about getting Gloria back.

"I was wrong," I said. "It was petty. I'm sorry."

"Do you know what you put me through, Scott Perkins?"

I just hung up.

I stood there with my face flaming.

"Scott?" My father was looking all over for me, calling me and calling me. "Scott! Are you here? The car's ready!"

All the way home, he lectured me on how contrary I was. Why couldn't I have waited to phone Al? What was it about me that made me just go ahead and do something I was expressly told I shouldn't do? "Just when I think we've gotten someplace," he said, "you turn around and go against my wishes.

"Why?" he shouted.

I said, "What?" I hadn't been concentrating on all that he was saying.

I was thinking that now she knew my name—don't ask me how—and now what was she going to do about it?

"I asked you why you go against my wishes," Dad said. "Nothing I say seems to register with you."

"It registers with me," I said. "I just seem to screw up sometimes."

"I can hardly believe my ears." He was smiling. "You actually said sometimes you screw up.

That's a new one."

"Yeah," I said. "That's a new one."

Then we both laughed, but I was still shaking, remembering Mrs. Whitman saying my name that way.

When we got in the house, Mom said, "The funniest thing happened while you were gone. The phone rang and this woman asked what number this was. I told her, and she asked whom she was speaking to. I told her and she said, 'Perkins...Perkins. Do you have a boy named Scott?' I said that we did, and she said, 'This is Martha Whitman. Tell him I'll see him this summer. I'm teaching remedial math.'"

I figured that right after I'd hung up from calling her about Gloria, she'd dialled *69. I'd heard you could do that. The phone would ring whoever called you last. That was why she'd asked my mother
what number it was and who was speaking.

Dad said, "You see, Scott, Mrs. Whitman doesn't dislike you, or she wouldn't have called here to tell you she'd see you this summer."

"I was wrong," I said. "Wrong again."

Oh, was I ever!

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

M.E.Kerr was born on May 27, 1927, as Marijane Agnes Meaker in Auburn, NY. She received a B.A. from the University of Missouri in 1949.

During her prolific writing career, she has published under the pseudonyms of M.E. Kerr, Ann Aldrich, Mary James and Vin Packer. At present, she is a member of PEN, the Authors League of America and the Society of Children's Book Writers. M.E Kerr is the winner of the 1993 Margaret Edwards Award for her lifetime achievement in writing books for young adults.

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KEY TERMS

dognapping: stealing someone's dog

anxious: worried or uneasy about something

pursed: lips pressed tightly together

nutsy: silly, crazy,

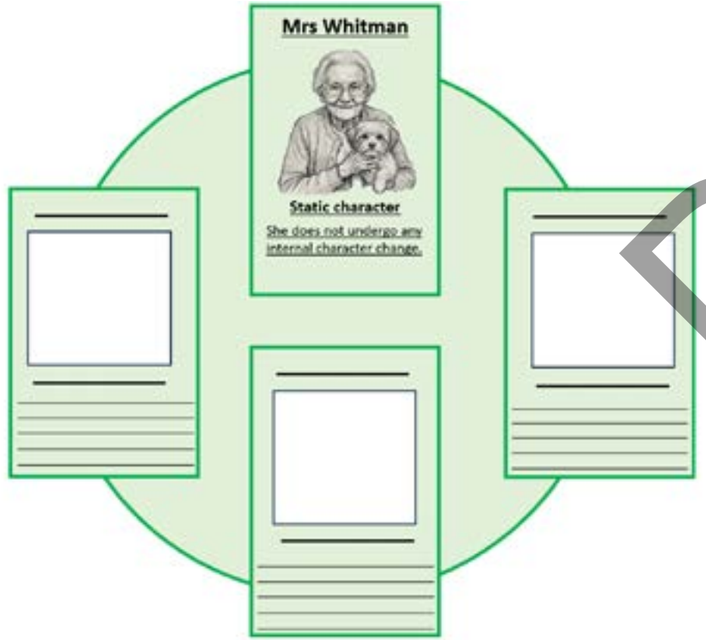
drooling: letting saliva run from the mouth

spiteful: wanting to hurt, annoy, or get revenge on someone.

LEARNING EXPERIENCE

1. Read the story individually. Then share a summary of the main elements with your shoulder partner.

2. Explore character types—dynamic, static, flat and round. Identify which character type best fits characters in the text. Sketch and explain the reasoning behind your classification. An example is done for you.



CONTINUED

3. Read the story aloud, taking turns with your group. As you listen to others read, look for the following information to fill in the table given below.

   a. examples of literary devices and their impact

   b. example(s) of the tone and how it affects meaning

   An example is done for you.

Story part	Literary device	What it shows	tone	How tone affects the story
She's a very valuable dog. / Not really. I got her from the pound.	irony	The dog is not actually expensive, but it is important to her.	funny/light	This makes the story funny and shows Scott's trick.

4. In pairs or groups, discuss how the story might be different in terms of descriptions, feelings, explanations, or the way events unfold if it were narrated in a traditional narrative style instead of a dialogue-driven style. After the discussion, share your ideas with the class.

5. In groups, list the phrasal verbs used in conversations between Scott, Mrs Whitman, and Scott's father. Complete the table below by matching each phrasal verb to its meaning. An example is done for you.

Phrasal Verb	Meaning	Sentence from the Story
hang up	End a phone call	I figured that right after I'd hung up from calling her about Gloria, she'd dialled *69. I'd heard you could do that.
blow up		
look up		
screw up		

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CONTINUED

6. a. Write a dialogue between Mrs Whitman and Scott on the first day of remedial Maths class. Each character should speak at least five times.

OR

b. Write a dialogue between Scott and his father after the first day of Maths remedial class. Each character should speak at least five times.

Helpful reminders

- Use quotation marks (‘ ’).
- Start a new line for each speaker.
- Add dialogue tages (‘He said’, ‘She whispered’).
- Use verbs such as said, asked, demanded, replied, muttered, whispered, and insisted.

REFLECTION

1. If you were Scott, would you have played the same prank? Share your reflection with your shoulder partner. Ensure to include the following points.
   - values that guided your decision
   - lessons you learnt from the consequences
   - your responsible solutions for the situation
2. Compare and contrast Mrs Whitman, a stereotypical teacher, with your teachers.

EXPLORE FURTHER

Too Soon a Woman by D. Johnson

DRAFT

The Big Story

George Loveridge

contemporary realistic fiction

GETTING STARTED

Refer to any Bhutanese newspaper and answer the following questions.

1. What is the most important story and why?
2. What is the next most important story?
3. What other stories are included in the paper?
4. If you were a newspaper reporter, where would you want your story to appear?
5. Is the information in the newspaper reliable? Why?

Ernie Gibson wanted to be a newspaper reporter. After he finished school he got a job at a small-town newspaper. Most of the time he worked in the News office, reading proof and checking facts. Sometimes he wrote about women's club meetings or high-school activities. Once in a while he handled routine police cases. His boss, a man named Truelove, covered everything that was interesting. Only if Truelove quit or dropped dead, Ernie said to himself, would he ever get a chance to show what he could do with a real story.

One morning Ernie was on his way back to the office with some notes he had taken about a dog show. The big story that day was a robbery in a supermarket. But Truelove was covering that.

It was hot and still early so Ernie decided to stop in at the Half Moon for a cup of coffee. As soon as he entered the coffee shop, the counterman said, "Hear about the drowning?"

"No. When?"

"Just now. Over at Willow Lake. Officer Trask was here and he got a call. He didn't even finish his coffee."

"Thanks," Ernie said.

He ran to his car and backed it quickly into the road. It took him less than ten minutes to drive to the lake, and he spent the time hoping and praying that Truelove hadn't heard the news.

In a meadow near the lake Ernie spotted a state police car. He went bumping across the field and parked beside it. Then he saw Officer Trask down by the bank, staring out into the water. Near him was a small pile of clothing.

"Who is it?" Ernie asked.

"Don't know for sure", Trask said. "A kid heard someone yell for help and found this pile of clothes. We're bringing a boat to look for the body."

"Any identification on the clothes?"

"An Army I.D. card—for a John Vollmer. There's a letter addressed to him, too. In the back pocket."

Ernie copied down the name and address—John Vollmer, 44 Cargill Street.

"When will the boat get here?"

"Here it comes now," Trask said.

The small boat was lifted off the trailer and launched quickly. One man rowed and another pulled grappling hooks through the water. Except for the ripples caused by the oars and the hooks, the lake was smooth and still.

"No telling how far out he was," Trask said.

Ernie nodded and watched for a few minutes. Then he said, "I'm going to check something."

"Okay."

Ernie drove to Cargill Street and found John Vollmer's house. When he rang the bell, a tall, gray-haired man came to the door.

"Does John Vollmer live here?" Ernie asked.

"Yes," the man said.

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"Is he here?"

"Not now."

"Are you his father?"

"Yes."

"I'm from the News," Ernie said. "I wanted to get a little information about him. Maybe you can help."

A stout woman came up behind the man. "What's the matter?" she asked.

"Why, nothing I know of," the man told her; then he turned back questioningly to Ernie.

"I heard your son was home," Ernie said. "We have a column in the News about servicemen, and I thought maybe I could write something about him."

"Yes, I see that column," the man said. "Come on in."

Ernie went into the front room, which was small and crowded with furniture. He stepped around a low table and saw a picture of a young man in an Army uniform. The television set in the corner was on, and the woman went over to it and turned down the volume.

"Have a seat," she said. "Johnny just got home from overseas. Just yesterday it was. He was over there more than a year, and I thought he'd never come back."

The father smiled. "It's tough on mothers. On fathers, too. Have some coffee, young man? We've got some on the stove."

"No, thanks," said Ernie. "Was he wounded?"

"Not a scratch, thank God," the woman said. "He came back safe and sound."

A pretty girl, about eighteen, came into the room. The woman smiled and said, "This is Johnny's sister—Margie. This young man is from the News. He's going to put something in the paper about Johnny."

"Why don't you turn off the TV, Mother?" the girl asked. "Then maybe he can hear better."

"I turned it down. Does it bother you, Mr.—?"

"Gibson, my name is. No. It doesn't bother me."

"All the time Johnny was gone, I didn't watch TV much," the woman explained. "I said to myself, 'What if something was happening to him and I was watching a show and enjoying myself?' You know what I mean? But now he's back and I watch it again."

Ernie nodded. Then he began asking all the questions he could think of: "When is John's birthday? Where did he go to school? How were his grades? Did he ever win any athletic awards? Does he have a girlfriend?"

Ernie took notes on the answers, but all the time he was writing he was also listening nervously for the ring of the telephone or a knock on the door.

"Sure you won't have a cup of coffee?" the father asked again.

"No, thanks."

"Maybe he'd like some ginger ale," said Margie.

"Would you, Mr. Gibson?"

"No, nothing. Thanks very much. Where is John now?"

"He went out," the mother said. "He got home just yesterday, and then this morning he decided he had to go out."

The father smiled. "Women. You can't please them. What's he want to sit around the house with us old people for?"

Margie said, "Johnny thought he might go over to Willow Lake for a swim. He used to swim there when he was a kid. He was going to do that or maybe look up some of his friends."

Ernie pointed to the picture of the soldier on the table. "Is that John? Could I borrow it?"

"Yes, but you'll be careful with it, won't you?" the mother said. "That's my best picture of Johnny."

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"Nothing will happen to it."

"Will you promise to bring it back?"

"Of course."

"He's a good boy," the woman said.

"You can put that in your story. He never forgets his mother. It was my birthday when he was over there, but he didn't forget. He sent his sister here some money to get me a present."
Ernie got up and took the picture from the table. "I'll return it," he said.
The father and mother stood up, too, and the father said, "When's this story going to be in the paper?"

Probably this afternoon.

"Soon as that? You work fast, you fellows don't you? I'll have to get a couple of extra copies. I'll send one to his grandmother."

Ernie said good-by.

"Come again," the mother said. "And be sure to bring my picture back."

"Yes," the father said. "Come back. I bet Johnny would like to meet you. Say, will this cost anything to—have the story in the paper?"

"No. Oh, no. Thanks. See you again."

Ernie hurried down the steps and got into his car and drove back to Willow Lake. About a dozen people were gathered on the bank of the lake. A doctor was trying to revive the body of a young man in blue swimming trunks. There was a cut on the young man's leg, probably from the grappling hook.

Ernie went up to the state trooper. "Can they help him?"

"No chance. Been in too long."

"Is it Vollmer?"

"Yeah," said Trask. "He's still wearing his Army dog tags."

Ernie nodded; then he looked around and saw a house on the other side of the meadow. He ran across the field and knocked on the front door.

A woman opened it and said, "Yes?"

Ernie gave his name and business and asked permission to use the telephone. "Trouble at the lake?" she asked.

"I'm afraid so."

The woman let him in and showed him where the telephone was.

Ernie called the newspaper office and started reading his notes to the rewrite man at the news desk. He spoke quickly and professionally, spelling out the name—"Vollmer. 'V' as in 'vinegar.' 'o' as in 'olive.'..."

Then he added, "I've got a picture of him. I'll bring it in. Leave space for it."

Ernie thanked the woman and went back to his car. As he drove away, he passed an ambulance heading for the lake.

He stopped for a quick lunch and then went back to the News office. After he turned in the picture of John Vollmer, Ernie leaned back in his chair, put his hands in his pockets and propped his feet on his desk.

Around three o'clock, Truelove came in with the afternoon News. "Well, you're on the front page with the story of the drowned soldier. You might have let me know about it. It's good work but—"

Ernie said, "Thanks." He put the newspaper on his desk but didn't look at it.

"And here," Truelove said. He pulled a brown envelope out of his pocket. "Here's the dead guy's picture. Someone said you wanted it back."

Ernie took the envelope and stared at it for a minute; then slowly he got to his feet. "I've got to go out," he told Truelove. "I'll be back soon."

Class IX English Textbook The Big Story

Once again Ernie drove to Cargill Street. This time he pulled up behind a police car that was parked in front of the Vollmer house.

Ernie ran up the steps and dropped the picture of John Vollmer into the mailbox near the front door. Then he walked back to his car and after a little while—not knowing what else to do—he drove away.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

George Loveridge is an American writer known for his realistic and engaging short stories. He focuses on ordinary people and everyday events, often highlighting human emotions, ethical dilemmas, and moral choices. Not many of his works are known beyond this story, but The Big Story' reflects a realistic style that highlights human emotions and everyday events, making it a valuable text for exploring themes of truth and responsibility.

KEY TERMS

grappling hooks: tools used to drag or pull something from the water

rewrite desk: a place in a newsroom where reporters dictate stories to editors who type them out

rewrite man: a person at the newspaper who listens to a reporter's information and rewrites it into a full news story

counterman: a worker behind the counter at a café or shop who serves customers

serviceman: a person who works in the military

trailer: a transport frame towed behind a vehicle

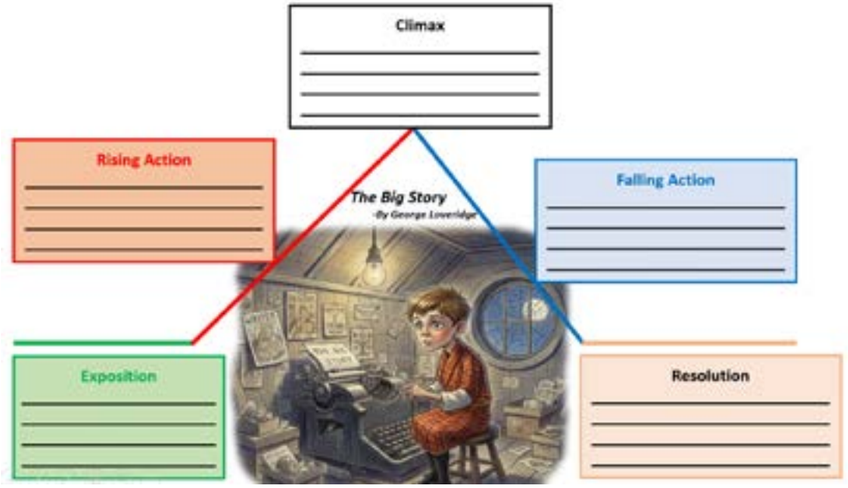
army dog tags: metal identification tags worn by military personnel

meadow: a field of grass or wildflowers

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LEARNING EXPERIENCE

1. Read the story to analyse the plot line and complete the template below.



2. How do Ernie's character traits influence his ethics as a reporter? Evaluate the way he reports John Vollmer's death in terms of fairness, accuracy, and impact, providing specific examples from the story.

3. Ernie expects to hear the telephone ring or a knock on the door while collecting information in Vollmer's house. Whom do you think he was expecting? Why?

4. Explore types of irony and complete the table below. An example is done for you

Type of Irony (Situational or Dramatic)	Evidence from the Text (Quote or Paraphrase)	Explanation
Situational Irony	Ernie thinks, 'Only if Truelove quit or dropped dead, ...would he ever get a chance to show what he could do with a real story.'	Ernie gets an opportunity to write his big story because of a tragic drowning. His success is thus built on someone else's misfortune, which is the opposite of a moment of success.

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CONTINUED

5. Study the information given in Table A to complete Table B.

Table A

Sentence	Modal	Mood	Tone
Ernie must hurry to the lake.	must	indicative	urgent
Could you tell me what happened?	could	interrogative	polite question
You should check the clothes first.	should	imperative or advisory	advice
He might still be alive.	might	indicative	uncertainty/hope

Table B

Sentence	Modal	Mood	Tone
When will the boat get here?			
You must bring it back.			
He might go to Willow Lake for a swim.			
If Truelove should quit. Ernie could get a chance.			

6. With a partner, write five principles that you think should be included in the code of ethics for news reporters. Provide a brief explanation of each principle. If possible, contact any news agency to compare their code of ethics with what you have constructed.

REFLECTION

1. Reflect on the story's central theme and discuss its relevance in the context of modern social media culture.
2. Ernie abandons his ethics to chase a sensational story. What kind of pressure, temptation, or ambition could drive you to cross a moral line in the same way?

EXPLORE FURTHER

The Parsley Garden by William Saroyan

The Romance of a Busy Broker

O. Henry

historical romance

GETTING STARTED

1. Study the images given below and answer the questions.



a. Individually, list 5 words or phrases related to each of the images.
b. Compare your lists with a partner and share ideas on how the ideas are represented in the images. Share ways in which your lists either contrast with or complement each other.

Pitcher, confidential clerk in the office of Harvey Maxwell, broker, allowed a look of mild interest and surprise to visit his usually expressionless countenance when his employer briskly entered at half past nine in company with his young lady secretary. With a snappy "Good-morning, Pitcher," Maxwell dashed at his desk as though he were intending to leap over it, and then plunged into the great heap of letters and telegrams waiting there for him.

The young lady had been Maxwell's secretary for a year. She was beautiful in a way that was decidedly unsecretarial. She dressed in a very simple manner. She wore no chains, bracelets or lockets. She had not the air of being about to accept an invitation to luncheon. Her dress was grey and plain, but it fitted her figure with fidelity and discretion. In her neat black turban hat was the gold-green wing of a macaw. On this morning she was softly and shyly radiant. Her eyes were dreamily bright, her cheeks genuine peachblow, her expression a happy one, with a touch of some sweet memory.

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Pitcher, still mildly curious, noticed a difference in her ways this morning. Instead of going straight into the adjoining room, where her desk was, she lingered, slightly irresolute, in the outer office. Once she moved over by Maxwell's desk, near enough for him to be aware of her presence.

The machine sitting at that desk was no longer a man; it was a busy New York broker, moved by buzzing wheels and uncoiling springs.

"Well—what is it? Anything?" asked Maxwell sharply. His opened mail lay in heaps on his crowded desk. His keen grey eye, impersonal and brusque, flashed upon her half impatiently.

"Nothing," answered the secretary, moving away with a little smile.

"Mr. Pitcher," she said to the clerk, "did Mr. Maxwell say anything yesterday about appointing another secretary?"

"He did," answered Pitcher. "He told me to get another one. I notified the agency yesterday afternoon to send over a few girls this morning. It's 9.45 o'clock, and not a single one has showed up yet."

"I will do the work as usual, then," said the young lady, "until someone comes to fill the place." And she went to her desk at once and hung the black hat with the gold-green macaw wing in its usual place.

He who has been denied the spectacle of a busy Manhattan broker during a rush of business is handicapped for the profession of anthropology. The poet sings of the "crowded hour of glorious life." The broker's hour is not only crowded, but the minutes and seconds are hanging to all the straps and packing both front and rear platforms.

There is no man busier than a New York broker. And this day was Harvey Maxwell's busiest day. The teleprinter began to send out lengths of tape, the desk telephone rang non-stop. Men began to throng into the office. Messenger boys ran in and out with messages and telegrams. The clerks in the office jumped about like sailors during a storm.

Suddenly Pitcher came in with a young girl.

"Lady from the Secretary''s Agency to see about the position," said Pitcher.

Maxwell turned half around, with his hands full of papers and teleprinter tapes.

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Class IX English Textbook The Romance of a Busy Broker

"What position?" he asked, with a frown.

"Position of secretary," said Pitcher. "You told me yesterday to call them up and have one sent over this morning."

"You are losing your mind, Pitcher," said Maxwell. "Why should I have given you any such instructions? Miss Leslie has given perfect satisfaction during the year she has been here. The place is hers as long as she chooses to retain it. There's no place open here, madam. Cancel that order with the agency, Pitcher, and don't bring any more of 'em in here."

The young lady left the office a little angrily. Pitcher seized a moment to remark to the bookkeeper that the "old man" seemed to get more absent-minded and forgetful every day that passed.

The rush and pace of business grew fiercer and faster. On the floor they were pounding half a dozen stocks in which Maxwell's customers were heavy investors. Orders to buy and sell were coming and going as swift as the flight of swallows. Some of his own holdings were imperilled, and the man was working like some high-geared, delicate, strong machine—strung to full tension, going at full speed, accurate, never hesitating, with the proper word and decision and act ready and prompt as clockwork. Stocks and bonds, loans and mortgages, margins and securities—here was a world of finance, and there was no room in it for the human world or the world of nature.

When the luncheon hour drew near, there came a slight lull in the uproar.

Maxwell stood by his desk with his hands full of telegrams and memoranda, with a fountain pen over his right ear and his hair hanging in disorderly strings over his forehead. His window was open, the spring air was pleasantly warm.

And through the window came a wandering—perhaps a lost—odour—a delicate, sweet odour of lilac that fixed the broker for a moment immovable. For this odour belonged to Miss Leslie; it was her own, and hers only.

The odour brought her vividly, almost tangibly before him. The world of finance dwindled suddenly to a speck. And she was in the next room—twenty steps away.

"By George, I'll do it now," said Maxwell, half aloud. "I'll ask her now. I wonder why I didn't do it long ago."

He dashed into the inner office. He charged upon the desk of the secretary.

She looked up at him with a smile. A soft pink crept over her cheek, and her eyes were gentle and smiling. Maxwell leaned one elbow on her desk. He still clutched fluttering papers with both hands and the pen was above his ear.

"Miss Leslie," he began hurriedly, "I have but a moment to spare. I want to say something in that moment. Will you be my wife? I haven't had time to show my love to you in the ordinary way, but I really do love you. Talk quick, please. I am very busy.

"Oh, what are you talking about?" exclaimed the young lady. She rose to her feet and gazed upon him, round-eyed.

"Don't you understand?" said Maxwell, restively. "I want you to marry me. I love you, Miss Leslie. I wanted to tell you, and I snatched a minute when things had slackened up a bit. They're calling me on the phone now. Tell 'em to wait a minute, Pitcher. Won't you, Miss Leslie?"

The secretary acted very strangely. At first, she seemed overcome with amazement; then tears flowed from her wondering eyes; and then she smiled cheerfully through them, and one of her arms slid tenderly about the broker's neck.

"I know now," she said softly. "It's this old business that has driven everything else out of your head for the time. I was frightened at first. Don't you remember, Harvey? We were married last evening at 8 o'clock in the Little Church Around the Corner".

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

O. Henry, whose real name was William Sydney Porter, was born in 1862 in the United States and is widely known as the "Master of the Short Story". He became famous for his surprising twist endings, humorous tone, and heart-warming stories that often highlight ordinary people experiencing extraordinary moments.

During his life, he wrote over 600 short stories. His works continue to be read and studied around the world for their humour, irony, and clever storytelling techniques.

Class IX English Textbook The Romance of a Busy Broker

KEY TERMS

restively: impatiently or nervously

fidelity: closeness or accuracy

slackened up: when activity slowed down or became less intense

broker: a person who buys and sells stocks for others

countenance: a person's face or facial expression

impersonal: not influenced by personal feelings

LEARNING EXPERIENCE

1. Read the story, and answer the following questions.
   a. What does the fragrance of lilacs remind Maxwell of, and what effect does it have on his actions? Explain your answer briefly..
   b. How does the author use the comparison of Maxwell to a 'machine'? Support your answer with evidence from the text.
   c. If you were Miss Leslie, how would you have responded to Maxwell forgetting your marriage? Justify your response.
   d. Do you think Maxwell's intense work habits can justify his forgetfulness about important personal events? Give reasons for your judgement.
   e. Identify the central idea of the story and explain it briefly. Support your answer with relevant details from the story.
   f. How does the use of foreshadowing make the ending of the story more credible?

2. a. Enact the office scene featuring Maxwell, Miss Leslie, and Pitcher, focusing on tone, facial expressions, and dialogue delivery.

   OR

   b. Create a storyboard, highlighting the main events.

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CONTINUED

3. Complete the table below by providing examples and their meanings or effects for the listed literary devices.

Device	Example from Text	What it Means/Why it's Effective
simile	The man was working like some high-powered…machine.	It helps to explain the extremely busy life of the broker, working efficiently.
metaphor		
personification		
hyperbole		
situational irony		
dramatic irony		
foreshadowing		

REFLECTION

Reflect on the importance of balancing love and work.

EXPLORE FURTHER

The Gift of the Magi by O. Henry

REVIEW

1. Illustrate the importance of empathy, courage and care in building human connection, in 'A Grain of Mustard Seed' and 'The Big Story'.
2. Compare the writing styles of Edith Pargeter and O. Henry to convey the main ideas in their stories.
3. How do the points of view differ in the four stories, and what effect do these have on the readers?
4. Which story shows a more realistic portrayal of everyday life, and why?
5. Identify one dominant literary device in each story and explain its purpose.
6. In 'I've Got Gloria' and 'The Romance of a Busy Broker', characters face challenges that require honesty, responsibility, and quick thinking. How can you apply these lessons in your lives, either at school or at home?
7. Which of the four stories taught you the most about ethical human behaviour, kindness, or responsibility? Use examples to support your answer.

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